

LOOPED

Written by
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BLACK

Ambient noise of a CLASSROOM. A clock ticks.

ALEX (OFF-SCREEN)
You're in a what?

JAKE (OFF-SCREEN)
A time loop.

INT. MATH CLASSROOM - DAY

People chattering, scribbles on a whiteboard, math posters litter the walls of a math class. In the middle, JAKE THOMPSON (18) and ALEX HERNANDEZ (18). Jake is dressed in some cutesy pajamas that he's way too old to be wearing, while Alex is trendily dressed, like the other students.

ALEX
What do you mean?

JAKE
I'm living the same day over and over again.

Alex shakes his head quickly in bewilderment and scoffs.

ALEX
Jake, you're an idiot.

Jake scoffs. Alex goes back to doing his work. After a second, he looks up. When Alex speaks, Jake mouths along.

ALEX
Okay, let's say you are in a time loop. How ca-

JAKE
Can I prove it?

Jake smiles cheekily. He reaches into his backpack and pulls out a large map. On the back of it is a connected string of dialogue, like an enormous choose your own video game in real life. On the top, it's titled 'The Alex Hernandez Dialogue Tree™.'

NOTE: Reference the dialogue tree used in Nathan Fielder's *The Rehearsal*.

JAKE
This is the 'Alex Hernandez Dialogue Tree.' It took me a few hundred loops to construct it, but here's how it works.

While explaining the dialogue tree, he points to various lines of dialogue.

JAKE

I've mapped out a few different paths of dialogue that show how you'll react if I tell you about certain things. Think of an NPC in a video game.

ALEX

(sarcastically)

Thanks, Jake.

(normal)

How do I know that you didn't just make this up?

Jake points to a box with Alex's question. He traces it along a line that says, "If I explain the map."

JAKE

That's the thing! You might think that I've just made it up. I haven't. I've sat through too many conversations about how your cheetah print underwear is just a bit too tight on you and how you pissed yourself a few nights ago for this to have been "*made up*"

Alex shoots a dirty look to Jake.

ALEX

(whispering)

Dude, shut up!

The math professor, MRS. HYNES (50s) chimes in.

MRS. HYNES

(stern)

Mr. Thompson, since you've been paying so much attention, could you please tell us what happens as x approaches two?

Jake doesn't initially turn around to face her, instead tracing his finger along a line that says, "When Mrs. Hynes assumes I don't know the answer." Alex looks on in amusement.

JAKE

(turning around to face

Mrs. Hynes)

(MORE)

JAKE (CONT'D)

As x approaches two from the negative side, y goes to infinity, and when x approaches two from the positive side, it goes to negative infinity.

Jake turns back around. Mrs. Hynes is a impressed.

MRS. HYNES

Alright, thank you, Jake. Pay a bit more attention, please!

Jake gives a goofy look to Alex, like, "see? look how awesome I am!" Alex rolls his eyes. He looks over and traces Jake's dialogue line to a box that says, "Alex will trace the dialogue line to this box." He then scrolls around the tree to a line that says "confess my love," but the box is empty.

ALEX

(playfully)

Oooh, you're finally saying that you love Sarah? It's taken long enough.

Jake looks down at the map and quickly folds it up. Alex wasn't supposed to see that. Alex squints inquisitively.

ALEX

Speaking of, where is she anyways?

Alex points to an empty desk, presumably where she sits. Jake doesn't look over.

JAKE

She's at some orchestra competition and doesn't get back until 6:00. Honestly, I don't think I've seen her in a few... weeks? Months?

ALEX

Oh, that sucks.

Jake shrugs.

JAKE

It's fine.

The bell RINGS. Students hurriedly pack up and leave.

MRS. HYNES

OK class! Remember that your limit definitions project is due tomorrow!

Jake and Alex pack up and step out of class.

INT. SCHOOL HALLWAY - LATER

Jake and Alex walk together down a hallway. Students litter the halls in a stream of chaos.

JAKE

Here's the thing, Alex: you're beginning to bore me.

ALEX

(scoffs, taken aback)
I'm sorry, what?

JAKE

Sorry, this whole loop has made me more blunt. It's just - I've spent so much time with you, and it's just... not interesting anymore. You just do the exact same thing every day, and there's only so much I can change in my life to change what you do. You feel me?

ALEX

(offended)
No, Jake. I don't 'feel you.' You sound like an asshole.

A girl, JENNA LEWIS (17, nerdy, carrying her books in a big bunch type, big glasses) walks down the hallway before tripping over her shoes. Jake stops her from falling.

JENNA

Oh, thank you!

JAKE

(indifferent)
Yup.

Jenna runs off to her class. Jake continues walking for a moment.

JAKE

(turns to Alex and stops)
Are you familiar with *Groundhog Day*, Alex? Don't answer that; I know that you are.

ALEX

What about it?

JAKE

Okay, so I'm at that point where Bill Murray realizes that everything he does is meaningless and starts killing himself repeatedly. I haven't gotten the balls to do it yet, but today I think I'm going to do something fun. Blow up a bridge or something; I'm not sure yet.

ALEX

If you kill yourself, what if it all ends there? What am I supposed to do when I show up to class tomorrow and everyone's asking where you are, and I have to sit there with a smile telling people: (mockingly)
"oh, Jake killed himself but he's in a time loop so he's fine!"

JAKE

See, you won't have to live with that though, 'cuz I'm *positive* the loop will continue.

ALEX

For you, yeah. But for me, you'll be dead, and I won't have anybody to cheat with for my exam tomorrow. You're being very selfish.

JAKE

(feigning distress)
Wow, I'm gonna be dead and all you care about is that you won't be able to cheat on your test?

Alex rolls his eyes, but chuckles.

ALEX

Think of it like this. For you, yesterday happened... when? A few weeks ago? A few months?

JAKE

(laughs)
I would say years, but honestly I have no idea how many todays I've had.

ALEX

Anyways, for me, yesterday was -

Alex looks at his watch.

ALEX

About ten hours ago. And in another fourteen hours, it'll be tomorrow for me. If you kill yourself, will this version of me have to live with that?

Jake thinks hard about this.

JAKE

Maybe? I'm not sure.

ALEX

'Maybe?' Shouldn't you know this stuff by now?

Jake shrugs.

ALEX

It just seems like you haven't thought this out very much. Why don't you give yourself a few more days to think it over before killing yourself?

Jake gives up his argument, throwing his arms up.

JAKE

Fine. You've convinced me. During the next loop, I'll kill myself before you can beg me not to, though.

ALEX

(relieved)

Thank you!

The two of them stand in silence. Alex looks on, waiting for Jake to do something interesting.

ALEX

Is that it? What's something cool you can do with your ability?

JAKE

Well, I know something we can do.

I/E. GAS STATION - AFTERNOON

Jake and Alex step into a GAS STATION. Jake walks right up to the GAS STATION ATTENDANT (20s), who's listening to music.

JAKE
Could I get a few lottery tickets?

GAS STATION ATTENDANT
(uninterested)
Which do you want?

On the counter is a colorful display of various lottery tickets. Jake playfully traces his finger around as if he's deciding on a ticket. He already knows which one he wants and selects one of the more expensive ones.

GAS STATION ATTENDANT
How many?

JAKE
I'll take the whole stack!

GAS STATION ATTENDANT
Uh, you sure? That's a few thousand dollars.

JAKE
(annoyed)
Do you not want my money?

The gas station attendant looks at Jake with some suspicion before ringing him up. Alex looks on with amusement and a little bit of infatuation with Jake. The attendant places the tickets on the counter in a tall stack.

GAS STATION ATTENDANT
That'll be...
(calculating total)
\$2,160.

Jake opens up his wallet. He only has a twenty.

JAKE
On second thought, just give me...

Jake points to one of the tickets toward the bottom of the stack.

JAKE (CONT'D)
That one.

The gas station attendant sighs before grabbing the card. Jake hands him the twenty and gets to scratching. **He's won \$5,000!**

GAS STATION ATTENDANT
(more interested)
Woah! Congrats.

JAKE
You want it? Here.

Jake flicks the card across the counter and begins to walk out.

GAS STATION ATTENDANT
Wow, thank you!

JAKE
(to Alex)
One of those tickets has the
jackpot but I haven't memorized it
yet.

Alex chuckles.

EXT. GAS STATION - CONTINUOUS

ALEX
Let's say I hypothetically believe
this time loop nonsense for a
second...

JAKE
...which you don't...

ALEX
You haven't done a good job at
convincing me yet!

JAKE
Have you not seen my dialogue tree?
How could I create that if I was
lying?

Jake reaches for the dialogue tree.

ALEX
The creepy map is... interesting...
but I want you to detail a day in
your life for me. That would
convince me.

Jake gets back up without it.

JAKE
Fine, but this never convinces you,
either. Each day begins at -

BEGIN FLASHBACK:

NOTE: During the flashback, most actions will be repeated two or three times to emphasize the time loop.

Flash to Jake's bedroom. It's a bit cluttered but not overly messy. On his desk -- an Xbox, some games, a monitor, his laptop, a copy of *Dante's Inferno*, some notes strewn about, and movie posters. One of them is *Groundhog Day*. -- Ironic.

On a bookshelf -- assorted trophies from random sports and ages, classic fantasy novels, and stacks of video games.

It isn't terribly messy, but looks lived in.

In his bed, Jake lies asleep in his pajamas. A slow push reveals the ALARM CLOCK. It hits **6:07 AM** on Monday, February 20th. BEEP, BEEP, BEEP!

JAKE (VO)

6:07 AM.

Jake's eyes suddenly open.

In one loop, he shouts in frustration. In another, he wakes up with a smile. In another, he slams the clock. After rolling out of bed, he walks to his closet.

In one loop, he puts normal clothes on. In another, he dresses up in a full suit. Now, he doesn't even bother.

JAKE (VO)

At this point, I've given up dressing for each day. Thankfully, I wake up in these stylish pajamas every day.

Cutting from the flashback, we see Jake showing off his pajamas with some pizzazz. Alex isn't impressed.

ALEX

Don't get distracted!

Back to the flashback.

JAKE (VO)

Right.

Jake steps out of his room into the upstairs hallway. He hops onto the railing of the stairs and - BOOM - he misses and crashes down the stairs. In another loop, he hops on and slides all the way down. Success!

INT. JAKE'S KITCHEN - MORNING

In the kitchen, we see ROBERT (40's, tough yet thoughtful), Jake's dad, preparing some scrambled eggs for breakfast. Sitting on his phone at the counter top is LUCAS (15, angsty and funny), Jake's younger brother.

Once he gets down the stairs, he SHOUTS. Robert and Lucas suddenly turn.

JAKE
Good morning, bitches!

Robert whips around quickly.

ROBERT
Who the hell do you think you're talking to?

In another loop, Jake sneaks up behind his dad. He peers over his shoulder at the eggs he's making.

JAKE
(loudly)
Great eggs, dad!

Robert is startled. He recovers quickly.

ROBERT
Good morning, J!

He ruffles Jake's hair and continues cooking.

ROBERT
Your mom's conference is running late, she's getting a later flight and should be home by dinner tonight.

JAKE
(mumbles)
I'd bet a thousand bucks she won't be!

Jake wasn't that quiet.

ROBERT
Oh, don't be ridiculous.
(beat)
Want some eggs?

Robert points to the scrambled eggs; they look great, but Jake politely declines.

JAKE

No, thanks! I've got to go. Super important project!

ROBERT

What project?

Jake is already walking out. On his way, he flicks Lucas on the back of the head. Lucas tries to grab for him, but Jake manages to get barely out of his reach. Lucas goes back on his phone.

In another loop, Jake pops out from under Lucas and SHOVES Lucas out of his chair.

In a third, he gives him a kiss on the head. Lucas swats at Jake.

LUCAS

What the -?

Jake skips over to the living room and walks to the fire place. Folded up is a TRAVEL MAP. Jake grabs that, then heads over to his dad's desk and grabs a pen. He puts both into his pocket before skipping out of the door.

ROBERT

(to Lucas)

Why is your brother wearing pajamas to school?

LUCAS

(on his phone)

How should I know?

Robert rolls his eyes. Typical teenage response. He goes back to his eggs.

I/E JAKE'S CAR / HIGH SCHOOL / MATH CLASSROOM - DAY

As Jake drives, he UNFURLS the blank map he grabbed earlier on his steering wheel and starts hurriedly writing on it. The map covers up his vision completely.

ALEX (V.O.)

Okay, how many times have you crashed doing that?

JAKE (V.O.)

Weirdly, I haven't.

Liar. Jake's writing is interrupted by a loud CRASH and the airbag DEPLOYING.

In another loop, Jake pulls into a parking spot in front of his school. His parking sucks.

We see a crowd of high school students flooding into WINTER PARK HIGH SCHOOL. The camera rises above, and we see the sea of students walking in from the left and right, with Jake walking through the center. We quickly transition between the same movement of the other students juxtaposed against:

Jake sprinting in with normal clothes.

Jake skipping in with a full suit.

Jake strolling in with Heelys and a bathing suit.

Jake walking in with his pajamas. Present day.

Jake walks into class and beelines over to Alex, who is scribbling some math down. Alex looks up at Jake's ridiculous pajamas.

ALEX
(while writing,
sarcastically)
Nice pajamas, Jake.

Jake goes to Alex's seat and SWIVELS him around.

ALEX
Hey! I'm still working!

JAKE
I need to tell you something.

ALEX
What is it?

JAKE
I'm stuck in a time loop.

ALEX
(laughing)
Okay...

Alex goes back to doing his work. Jake quickly grabs and spins him around.

JAKE
(serious)
I've never been more serious about something in my life. I've lived this day hundreds of times before.

ALEX
(more serious)
I'm sorry, you're in a what?

JAKE
A time loop.

END FLASHBACK:

EXT. GAS STATION - SAME AS EARLIER

JAKE
I mean, that's an average day for me, but, like, I'm not an idiot, so I don't go to school every day. I went through this period where I'd watch movies all day long, and I want to say I've seen, like, two thousand movies. I can't really track them because... you know, the day loops.

ALEX
Two thousand movies? I never thought of you as a movie person.

JAKE
I mean, I guess I wasn't a movie person yesterday.

Jake's phone RINGS, but he ignores it.

ALEX
You don't take your calls? I guess you probably know who that's from.

JAKE
It's Sarah. She's in tears right now and desperately needs me to comfort her.
(mockingly)
Not today!

ALEX
You sound like a terrible boyfriend.

JAKE
Alex, I have been the greatest boyfriend in the world hundreds of times to her. I proposed to her once, did you know that?

Alex raises his eyebrows.

ALEX
Really?

Jake nods.

ALEX
(laughing)
What?! How'd that work out?

JAKE
(fake outrage)
She rejected me!

ALEX
(playing along)
No way!

JAKE
(shaking head)
Women...

Alex's phone CHIMES. He pulls it out of his pocket to check his text, but Jake interrupts him.

JAKE
Don't go to the party. It sucks.
Actually, it's pretty fun but after
so many loops it isn't interesting
anymore.

Jake slides Alex's phone to him slowly. As he's dragging:

ALEX
Party?

Jake points down. Alex checks his text and sees: **"PARTY @
STERLING'S TONIGHT. BYOB."**

ALEX
Well, even if you've had your share
of Sterling's parties, I'll still
be attending. Let's go!

The two get in Jake's car and drive off.

EXT. ALEX'S HOUSE - LATER

Jake pulls up to Alex's house. Alex exits Jake's car, then turns around to face Jake through his window.

ALEX

So, I'm not gonna see you tonight?

Jake shakes his head.

JAKE

Not **tonight**, tonight. Another tonight, definitely!

ALEX

Shame. I might be boring you, but you're more interesting than you've ever been.

Alex turns away and starts to walk before quickly turning around.

ALEX

Wait, so when I go to bed what's going to happen to you?

Jake shrugs.

JAKE

I suppose you'll wake up with a new version of me. Maybe a cooler one from another universe.

ALEX

(crossing fingers)

Let's hope for a better one!

The two share a prolonged glance at each other. Jake doesn't know what to say.

JAKE

(awkwardly)

See ya tomorrow.

Alex nods. Jake chuckles, then **speeds off**. Alex looks at the ground for a second, thinking about the wild day he had. He walks to his house.

INT. JAKE'S KITCHEN - EVENING

Jake enters the house and walks to the stairs, through the kitchen. Robert's been preparing dinner: glazed salmon, broccoli, and rice. Robert starts speaking, and Jake mouths along.

ROBERT

Dinner! I've made your favorite!

JAKE
(somewhat patronizing)
Salmon and day-old rice?

ROBERT
That's right! Good guess. Can you
get your brother down here?

Jake walks to the stairs and suddenly starts to shriek,
startling Robert:

JAKE
(fake panic)
LUCAS! GET DOWN NOW! SOMETHING
HORRIBLE HAS HAPPENED! DAD'S DYING!

Robert rolls his eyes, but eagerly looks up the stairs to see
how Lucas responds.

Lucas exits his room calmly with headphones on while texting.

LUCAS
(uninterested)
What's up?

Jake sighs, disappointed at Lucas's lack of reaction.

JAKE
We're having dinner.

LUCAS
(texting)
What is it?

JAKE
Why, are you planning on not eating
it?

ROBERT
(to Lucas, singsongy)
I've made your favorite!

LUCAS
Let me guess: salmon and old rice?

ROBERT
Am I that predictable?

JAKE AND LUCAS
Yes.

LUCAS
Give me one second, dad.

Lucas walks back into his room.

Robert finishes setting up the table. He plops a scoop of microwaved rice onto each plate and scoops some decent-looking broiled salmon.

Jake grabs three water glasses and fills them up. After placing them down, he sits down. Robert walks up to get Lucas.

ROBERT
Where is that boy?

JAKE
(to Robert)
Don't bother, he'll open the door...
(beat)
...now.

Right on cue, Lucas opens the door. He trudges down the stairs, rocking to music and playing a video game.

As he comes down, Robert pulls the headphones off. They both sit down with Jake. After eating for a moment:

ROBERT
So, Lucas, how are your classes?

Lucas's mouth is full of food, but he responds anyways.

LUCAS
(garbled)
They're easy.

ROBERT
Chew your food.

Lucas swallows and continues.

LUCAS
I don't know, I like my art class a lot because my teacher lets me play on my phone.

ROBERT
(sarcastically)
Ah, a quality education!
(beat)
Jake, what about you?

Jake shrugs.

ROBERT
Nothing? What are you doing all
day, then?

JAKE
(matter-of-fact)
I've been in a time loop for the
last few years, and each day is the
same for me. In terms of education,
my film class is pretty good.

ROBERT
A time loop? Fun!

JAKE
(sarcastically)
Yeah, super fun.

LUCAS
I wish I could've been in film
class.

ROBERT
Why didn't you pick it?

LUCAS
The teacher didn't pick me. It's a
bit competitive, I guess.

JAKE
You should see the kids in there.
Competitive, my ass.

Lucas goes onto his phone and texts. Jake pulls his phone
out, too. A beat.

ROBERT
You know, when I was in school, we
didn't have these soul-sucking
devices to distract ourselves.
Every day, we'd have to do *crazy*
things like read or play outside.

Lucas rolls his eyes. Robert grabs his phone.

The family all sits together, eating in silence. Robert's
phone goes off, and he reads a text message.

LUCAS
Hypocrite!

ROBERT

Oh, hush. I'm an adult. Looks like mom won't be home until tomorrow morning. Her flight got delayed.

Out of nowhere, Jake **slams** the table. Robert is confused at the sudden burst.

ROBERT

What the hell is wrong with you?

Jake rolls his eyes.

JAKE

Nothing. I'm going upstairs.

As he exits, Robert and Lucas look at each other uncomfortably. Jake walks up the stairs without any anger on his face. After he's upstairs:

ROBERT

So, Lucas, what else is going on?
Any new girls?

LUCAS

(laughs)
Dad, stop. You're ridiculous.

The two continue eating.

INT. JAKE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT / MORNING

Jake walks into his room.

Jake opens his backpack and pulls out the dialogue tree from earlier. The map's vastness is outstanding. He puts in earbuds and bobs his head to music.

He traces through the day that he's had, starting with a box marked: "**Mess with R + L @ breakfast,**" then to "**explain loop to Alex.**"

As he traces through his day, we see various lines that lead to different outcomes. As he looks at the box marked "gas station," he has multiple lines drawn for the different lottery tickets he receives, if he donates his ticket to the attendant or gives it to Alex.

One line is marked "**ARMED ROBBERY,**" but no box exists from that. Jake circles it with a pen.

JAKE

I'll discover you tomorrow.

At the square marked **"dinner w/ fam"**, he draws a new line **"get rilly angry for no reason @ mom talk."** He draws a box that says **"no huge reaction, dad = mad."**

For a beat, he looks at what he's created. Jake smiles.

He walks over to his computer, opens it up, and navigates to a gambling website. A series of bets are about to finish.

JAKE
(to self)
In 3...2...

It's a **BIG WIN!** Jake cashes out a few thousand dollars worth of very specific sports bets.

He logs onto Twitch and finds a STREAMER (18, gamer dude) without any viewers. He gives a donation of **\$25,000** with a note "spend it all before the day ends, pls!"

The streamer reacts with shock.

STREAMER
(doesn't believe it)
Wait... what?

He leans into his computer to verify.

STREAMER
Holy shit!! \$25,000?! Is this serious?! Thank you so much, fartwarrior123!

Jake smiles faintly. It's not enough, though. He looks at the time and moves onto the next website.

After typing in the URL, he's brought to a page:

Be our 100,000,000th account and win \$1,000,000!

He spams the keyboard with account details and clicks submit. He looks at the time: 10:01:23 PM

You are: User 99,999,999.

JAKE
Fuck!

He walks to the map and marks: Create account @ **10:01:24-26 PM.**

He goes to a third tab, a PIZZA SHOP. He order 150 meat lovers pizzas and places a generous tip. The note again: **"Spend all the money ASAP"**

Later, Jake stands in the bathroom. He looks into the mirror and tries on various facial expressions. He sprays the whole thing down with shaving cream.

In the shower, Jake SCREAMS ALONG to music.

Lucas stands outside the door.

LUCAS
Dude! Shut up!!

Jake doesn't listen. Suddenly, an electrical SHOCK runs through his body, stunning him briefly. His earbuds are shot.

Back to the map, Jake puts a note: **"DO NOT SHOWER WITH
EARBUDS IN"**

He looks proudly at the map and TEARS IT UP. He walks to his laptop and SNAPS IT IN HALF

After reminiscing over some of the previous experiences he's had, he tears the map up and gets ready for it to reappear tomorrow morning.

Jake hops into bed with a smile. Downstairs, he overhears:

ROBERT
(muffled)
WHICH ONE OF YOU ORDERED 150
PIZZAS?!

Jake smiles. We push into the clock: **11:32 P.M.**

MATCH CUT TO:

6:07 A.M. Jake's eyes suddenly open, and he turns to his side to rest for a moment.

JAKE
(to self)
Ready for another day, Jake?

Jake looks toward his closet. He puts on something plain before exiting and walking down the stairs.

INT. JAKE'S KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS

Robert is cooking breakfast. Scrambled eggs, again.

JAKE
(cheerfully)
Morning, dad!

ROBERT
Good morning, J.

He ruffles Jake's hair and continues cooking.

ROBERT
Oh, your mother called: She'll be home by dinner tonight.

JAKE
(sarcastically)
So excited!

ROBERT
Want some eggs?

Robert points to the eggs. Jake normally declines, but today:

JAKE
Sure. Thanks.

Jake goes over to the table and sits down. Jake is sitting on his phone at the counter.

ROBERT
Lucas! Sit at the table and eat!

LUCAS
I'm not hungry.

ROBERT
Nonsense! Sit with us!

Lucas looks up and rolls his eyes.

LUCAS
Alright.

The three sit down at the table and eat.

ROBERT
So, Jake, what are you doing today?

JAKE
Oh, you know, the usual.

ROBERT
Which is?

JAKE
I dunno. There's a party tonight. I might go to that.

Lucas and Robert look at each other. Robert turns his attention back to Jake.

ROBERT

Well, if you're drinking tonight,
make sure you're safe. Under **no**
circumstances do I want you driving
home, do you understand?

JAKE

(with obnoxious salute)
Sir, yes, sir!

LUCAS

Wait, since when is he allowed to
drink? Can I?

ROBERT

Absolutely not.

LUCAS

Ugh, you're the worst!

Robert shoots a nasty look at Lucas. That shuts him up.

ROBERT

Eat your breakfast.

Lucas goes back to eating.

JAKE

Well, I've got to get going.

ROBERT

Wait, why are you leaving so early?

JAKE

I've got a project... remember?

Robert looks confused.

ROBERT

Remember what?

Jake gets up, grabs the map and a pen, then heads to his car
to go to school.

INT. MATH CLASSROOM - DAY

Jake walks into the classroom. Alex looks up at his pajamas.

ALEX
(while writing;
sarcastically)
Nice pajamas.

Jake SLAMS the map onto Alex's desk.

JAKE
Ready to hear something crazy?

SKIP EXPLANATION
AND CUT TO:

Alex stares at Jake with his mouth slightly agape. After a beat:

ALEX
Okay, well, let's assume that you
are in this time loop. What number
am I thi-

JAKE
Alex, just quit it with the games
and believe me! I hate having to
explain this to you.

Alex throws his hands up in defeat.

ALEX
Alright. I believe you!

Jake gives Alex a smug look.

ALEX
So... what's on the agenda for
today?

Jake looks around the room for something to do and overhears
a conversation between two students:

STUDENT #1
Are you going to Sterling's party
later?

Bingo! Jake turns back to Alex.

JAKE
Alex, you don't know about
Sterling's party yet, but that's
what we're doing tonight.

ALEX
It's Monday.

JAKE
Even better! Let's get the weekend
started with *style*.

Jake pokes Alex playfully.

ALEX
Are you even friends with him?

JAKE
We go way back!

Alex raises his eyebrow.

JAKE
(caving)
Okay, I don't actually *know him*
know him, but his party will be
pretty fun.

ALEX
(suspicious)
You hate parties.

JAKE
It depends on how much I drink! Too
much, and... bleh. Being blacked
out with you is funny, though.

ALEX
(laughs, convinced)
Sounds like a blast.

The bell RINGS.

MRS. HYNES
OK class, remember that your limit
definitions project is due
tomorrow!

While Mrs. Hynes is speaking, Jake walks out.

INT. SCHOOL HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Jake walks through the crowded hallway with Alex. Jenna, the
girl from earlier, is walking far behind them.

JAKE
Quickly, turn around.

Jake and Alex turn around.

JAKE
See that girl?

ALEX
Oh, her? That's, uh... who is she?

Jake shakes his head. If he did know who she was, he doesn't know anymore.

JAKE
Every day she forgets to tie her damn shoes and... if I don't catch her from falling, she is going to have a very painful day.

Jake pulls out a coin from his pocket.

JAKE
(showing heads)
Heads says I catch her, tails says I let her hit the ground.

Jake gets ready to toss the coin, but Alex covers his hand and gives him a mean look.

JAKE
What?

Alex continues to stare him down.

ALEX
Seriously, dude?

JAKE
Relax, she'll be fine tomorrow.

ALEX
You're an asshole.

Alex gives a hard stare to Jake. This convinces him. Jake throws up his hands.

JAKE
Fine! I'll save her today.
Tomorrow, though, she's hitting the ground.

Alex rolls his eyes. As soon as Jake finishes talking, she begins to trip. Jake lunges forward and catches her, making sure that none of her books fall.

JENNA
Thank you!

JAKE

Yup. See you tomorrow!

Jenna scurries ahead of them. Alex thinks about what her name is as she walks away.

ALEX

Jamie!

JAKE

What?

ALEX

That's her name!

JAKE

Her name doesn't matter. I have this theory I'm the main character in a video game and saving her from tripping is one of those fun side quests.

ALEX

(dumbfounded)

What is wrong with you?

Jake and Alex keep going. After arriving in front of a classroom door adorned with various film elements. Jake looks at the door, but doesn't go in.

ALEX

Not going to class today?

JAKE

Nah. Remember that big film project I was working on?

ALEX

Yeah, why?

JAKE

Well, if I go in, Mrs. Washington is going to tell me that I didn't even place at competition.

(beat)

I haven't been to class for months now. It's too big of a hit to my ego.

ALEX

You and your ego. I couldn't name a more inseparable duo.

We hold on a two shot of our second-most inseparable duo.

JAKE

Oh, by the way, you're about to
BOMB a history test.

ALEX

Wow, reassuring! Thanks.

Jake pulls out a pen and grabs Alex's hand. While talking,
Alex looks into Jake's eyes momentarily.

JAKE

(while writing, a bit
distracted)

Fortunately... I've got the answers
for you. Wait a few minutes before
checking your hand, otherwise Mrs.
Molina catches you cheating and
will call you out in front of
everybody. Talk about an ego
killer.

ALEX

Got it. Thanks, Jake. I gotta go
now.

Jake nods at Alex. Jake watches Alex walk away before turning
his own way and walking down the hallway.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. JAKE'S BEDROOM - EARLY EVENING

Jake walks into his room. He starts rummaging through his
clothes to get ready. He pulls up his dialogue tree and looks
over at the "STERLING'S PARTY" section. On it, we start at a
box labeled: "What outfit?," and as he looks at his different
outfits, we see lines connecting them to different outcomes.

JAKE

(while flicking through
clothes)

Already done... did that...
check...

Once he looks through most of his clothing, it appears that
he's gone in almost every outfit he owns...

...except for a full suit.

JAKE

Full suit? Let's do it.

Jake gets into the suit. After most of the clothes are on, he starts putting on his shoes. Suddenly, a KNOCK.

JAKE
Come in, Lucas!

Lucas, dressed in a childish *Fortnite* shirt and basketball shorts, walks into the room timidly.

JAKE
What's up, buddy?

LUCAS
Can I come to Sterling's party? My friends are going and dude, you **owe** this to me after what you did yesterday.

JAKE
What'd I do yesterday?
(a beat, thinking)
It doesn't matter. No.

Lucas puffs with rage storms out of the room. Jake shrugs. Whatever. He continues putting on his shoes. He looks over at the dialogue tree.

On the dialogue tree, we see that on a box marked "Lucas asks me to go to the party," there's only one line connecting it: "Absolutely not."

While looking at it, Jake scoffs.

JAKE
(to self)
Why would I invite him? He'd just make everything worse.

He goes back to tying his shoes, but after a beat he GROANS. He finishes tying his shoes and quickly gets up before leaving the room.

INT. LUCAS'S BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Jake opens Lucas's bedroom. His room is substantially more messy than Jake's.

Lucas is sitting on his bed, scrolling through his phone. He notices Jake, but keeps looking at his phone.

LUCAS
Get out, Jake.

Jake looks like he's about to say something mean, but takes a deep breath and readjusts.

JAKE
Look, Lucas, I'm sorry. I really am.

LUCAS
I don't care.

JAKE
Lucas, I promise I'll change in the future.
(beat)
But... since that's not coming any time soon, I suppose I can be nicer to you now. That being said, do you want to go to the party with me?

Lucas looks up from his phone.

LUCAS
(hopeful)
Wait, really?

JAKE
Of course! It's the least I can do for you.

Lucas hops out of bed quickly.

LUCAS
(rushing Jake)
Let's go!

JAKE
Woah, you've gotta change before we can leave.

Lucas looks down at his ridiculous outfit.

LUCAS
(overconfident)
I'm a stud already. Why would I need to change to impress the ladies when they already love me?

Lucas walks over and smugly spritzes some cologne onto himself.

LUCAS
(confidently)
Let's go get some girls.

JAKE
(laughs)
You're ridiculous. Let's go.

INT. JAKE'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Jake and Lucas walk down the stairs. Robert is watching a move in the living room.

JAKE
Bye, dad! We'll be back later!

ROBERT
That's great, just don't do
anything stupid!
(realizing that he said
"we")
Wait, we?!

LUCAS
I'm heading out, too!

The two walk out of the house.

I/E STERLING'S HOUSE - EVENING

Jake and Lucas arrive at a nice house. A few teenagers loiter around the outside, but loud THUMPING of party music can be heard, and the windows flash multi-colored lights.

Jake and Lucas turn to each other.

JAKE
Ready?

LUCAS
Let's go.

Jake and Lucas flip down shades and walk in. Cool guys.

As they walk into the house, they're bombarded with loud music and a crowd of people moving.

Lucas looks overwhelmed, but Jake grabs him by the arm and leads him through the crowd to his kitchen.

On the table in front of the two we see a smorgasbord of alcohol. Handles of half-empty vodka containers are scattered amongst an array of colorful liquors.

JAKE

See that?
(points to some tequila)
Don't drink that one, it tastes
like shit. This one, on the other
hand -
(points to a plain looking
vodka handle)
Will get you fuuucked.

He gives himself a **hefty pour** of the vodka and hands the
handle to Lucas.

JAKE

Here you go!

LUCAS

Am I supposed to pour it myself? I
don't even know how much I'm
supposed to drink.

Jake shrugs.

JAKE

(shouting over the music)
Just drink until your head starts
feeling funny!

Horrible advice. Lucas takes it anyways, gives himself a nice
pour, and clinks cups with Jake. The night is off!

After downing the alcohol, Lucas starts to violently cough.
Jake finds an open gallon of lemonade.

JAKE

Here, use this as a chaser!

LUCAS

Would've been nice to know that
before...

Jake is pulled aside by somebody. It's Alex, who is **very
drunk**. He leans against the hallway.

ALEX

Oh my god! You made it, Jake!

Lucas awkwardly looks around before locking eyes on a PRETTY
GIRL, at least a few years his senior.

LUCAS

(shouting)
Hey, there! Are you looking for a
bit of young love tonight?

The girl looks at Lucas's outfit and laughs to her friend, Lucas walks over anyways.

Back to Jake and Alex, who are walking through the house. Well, Jake is walking; Alex is **stumbling**.

ALEX

How are you doing, buddy?

Jake gives a ridiculous smile. No matter how many times he sees Alex like this he still finds it hilarious.

JAKE

(amused)

I'm fine. How much have you had to drink?

Alex tries to count on his fingers.

ALEX

Well, I had one shot, then another, then shotgunned a beer, then another shot, and I just took one more. That's... what? Three shots?

JAKE

(chuckles)

I don't think your math is adding up.

ALEX

I think that you haven't had enough to drink. Take a few more shots.

JAKE

Alright, big man! Pour me!

Alex goes to pour a couple more shots for Jake. He spills alcohol all over. Jake downs all the shots in a row without any reaction while Alex looks on in dopey astonishment.

Jake pulls Alex into the living room and to the center of the mob. It's a colorful mess of loud party music and sweaty teenagers jumping senselessly.

We see Jake progress through the night, switching between more shots and partying throughout the house.

Jake slows down and collapses in a seat in the foyer. After a moment, the front door opens.

For the first time, we see SARAH WELLS (17, gorgeous, closed off) walk through the door. **Oh shit**. Jake hops out of his seat and tries to look confident.

JAKE
Looking good, babe.

SARAH
(disgusted)
Oh... hey, Jake.

Jake goes in for a big kiss. She's not having it.

JAKE
What's wrong? Oh, let me guess,
you're PMSing again?

Ew. Jake immediately cringes at himself.

SARAH
(convictive)
Funny. You wanna apologize for that
one?

JAKE
Yeah, probably shouldn't have said
that.

An uncomfortable beat. For a high school couple, these two
are especially awkward.

SARAH
Look, Jake. I came here to talk to
you. Mind if we move somewhere
separately?

Jake knows what's coming next. Ugh. He drunkenly walks over
to the kitchen.

JAKE
Let me guess: you're mad because
you failed your orchestra
performance?

SARAH
I - how did you know that? I didn't
tell you.

Jake shrugs.

SARAH
Whatever.

Jake and Sarah sit down next to each other.

SARAH
I'm not sure how to say this, Jake.
We just... don't connect anymore.
(MORE)

SARAH (CONT'D)

For the last few weeks you've been so distant and I'm not sure if you're just pulling away because of something else or if it's my fault.

JAKE

It's something else.

She figured.

SARAH

Is it some**one** else?

JAKE

God, no!

Is it? Jake doesn't seem so sure on a second thought.

SARAH

(getting up)

Right. Um, I have to go.

Sarah gets up. She balls her fists up and works up some courage.

SARAH

I... we should take a break. This isn't working.

JAKE

You know, you've broken up with me a thousand times. I just don't get it, is there no way you'll change your mind?

Sarah has no idea what the hell Jake is talking about.

SARAH

I... what? I don't know what you're talking about, J.

JAKE

Forget it. It's fine, we'll go our own direction. We're mature adults.

The two occupy the same space for a moment. **Mature adults.** Sarah leaves.

Jake lays at the table before looking across the house at the outside porch. Alex is walking to sit outside. Jake follows.

As he leaves, we catch up with Lucas. In the kitchen, he's sitting with the girl from earlier and her friend, wrapped around his arms. The little guy's got serious pull.

LUCAS

So, ladies. What do you say we take this upstairs?

PRETTY GIRL

You're cute.

Both girls give him a kiss on the cheek at the same time. Does he get with them? Probably not. We don't stick around to find out.

EXT. STERLING'S BACKYARD - CONTINUOUS

Jake slides open the door and steps out. The sound of the party is drowned as he makes his way down to the backyard. Alex is sitting on a lawn chair facing the lake. Jake stumbles to a seat next to Alex.

While Jake is clearly too drunk to fully comprehend how beautiful the night is, he stares out into the lake for a moment and relaxes.

The two are still clearly a bit drunk but coming off of it slightly.

A beat. At the same time:

ALEX

How's the night been?

JAKE

Sarah just broke up with me.

Alex sits up.

ALEX

Wait, what?

JAKE

Yeah, she does this every night.

ALEX

I thought -

JAKE

I lied. I never break up with her. I don't have the heart to do it. No matter what I do, she walks in to this party and breaks up with me. That's why I don't usually go.

ALEX

I'm sorry to hear that. I'm always here for you, dude.

The two sit in silence. Jake sits and thinks about what he's going to say next. After a beat:

JAKE

I -

He decides not to say it.

ALEX

What?

Fuck it.

JAKE

I've been thinking about this for a long time.

ALEX

Thinking about what?

JAKE

Can you keep a secret?

Alex nods.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Do you know what the worst part of being trapped in this loop is? It's not that I get dumped by my girlfriend every single time I see her without fail. It's not the fact that I wake up in this stupid city in the middle of February and I can't do anything to change it. It's not the knowing that my life can't add up to anything because there are literally no consequences for my actions. You want to know what it is?

(beat)

It's the fact that I have sat here on this day for my entire life knowing that I am in **love with you**.

Alex coughs violently. Jake continues rambling.

JAKE (CONT'D)

I've wasted the last few years dating Sarah when I knew that the person who I *really* belong with is you. I know everything there is to know about you, but I've never been able to work up the courage to just tell you how I feel. But...

(MORE)

JAKE (CONT'D)

(he chokes up)
...even though I'm telling you this
now, I won't get to live with this.
You are the one constant in my life
that I'll never get to have.

Alex looks on into the distance; the foundation of his
closest friendship has just been shattered.

ALEX

I...

Jake puts on a wry smile.

JAKE

It's okay, you won't remember
anyways.

Suddenly, Lucas pulls the patio door open. He's still drunk,
but a phone call with his dad has sobered him up a bit.

LUCAS

(yelling across the
backyard)
Jake! It's 11:00 and we haven't
left yet. Dad is **pissed**.

JAKE

(not facing Lucas)
Whooo cares about dad?

LUCAS

(shouting, cups ear to
hear better)
What?

JAKE

(to Alex)
This fuckin' guy.

Alex nods his head softly. He's still focused on Jake's
confession. Lucas is frustrated.

LUCAS

Jake?!

Lucas starts to jog over to Jake, but trips on the way over
in his drunkenness. He gets back up and walks to Jake.

LUCAS

Get up! We've got to go.
(to Alex)
Hey, Alex.

ALEX
(quietly)
Hey, Lucas.

LUCAS
How are you?

ALEX
(staring forward)
Uh...

JAKE
Let's go!

Jake rockets out of his seat and stares at Alex for a second. Alex doesn't look up.

As Jake walks away, we hold on Alex, who looks emotionally devastated. After a beat, he quickly gets out of his chair.

ALEX
Jake, wait!

He's already inside. Alex sits back down slowly and looks out to the lake again.

INT. JAKE'S HOUSE - THAT NIGHT

Jake and Lucas STUMBLE into their house. Robert is still watching a movie in the living room. Jake tries to sneak through, though his attempts are feeble.

ROBERT
Jake! Come here...

Fuck. Jake tries to shake himself sober for a second, before looking in a mirror and shrugging. He doesn't care.

Jake drunkenly walks over to Robert, who pauses the movie. Lucas hugs the corner and stays out of sight. Jake desperately tries to seem sober.

JAKE
Hello, dad.

Robert gestures for Jake to sit on the couch with him.

ROBERT
(sternly)
Jake. You're drunk.

JAKE
(slowly)
No. You are drunk.

Robert gives Jake a stern look for a second before bursting into laughter. This somewhat surprises Jake.

ROBERT
Look. I was a teenager once, too.
I'd hate it when my parents would
reprimand me for drinking too much.
Tonight, it's fine. Just... don't
make it a habit. The road to
addiction is a dark place and I
don't want to see you end up like
my father.

Jake nods his head for a second before starting to sob quietly. This surprises Robert.

JAKE
Dad, I love you so much, and I know
I don't say it very much, but even
if you don't remember today I will.
It's been such a long time since
I've seen mom, and you're always
the one here for me; I don't always
show my appreciation, but it's nice
that I can wake up every morning
and you're making breakfast even
though I get sick of eggs after so
long.

Jake leans into his dad's chest and gives him a hug. Robert is a bit taken aback by his speech but returns the hug anyways.

ROBERT
I love you, too, J.
(beat)
Alright. It's time for bed!

Robert picks Jake up and gives him a little push. Jake stumbles upstairs to his bed. Robert resumes his movie. Lucas tries to sneak past.

ROBERT
Lucas... not so fast!

Lucas turns toward Robert.

ROBERT

Dude, you're fifteen. Cool it on
the partying until you're a senior
or something, alright?

Lucas gives a stupid thumbs up and walks up to his room.
Robert sits on the couch and looks at the mantle. Resting on
top is a photo of a MUCH YOUNGER ROBERT, at a party with his
friends.

Robert gets up and picks up the image. The younger version of
him looks a lot like Jake. He smiles and puts it down.

INT. JAKE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT / DAY

After getting back in his bedroom, Jake looks at the alarm
clock. **11:59 PM, FEBRUARY 20th.**

JAKE

(pointing at clock)

You. I hate you.

He walks to his bed and plops down. After a few seconds, he
falls asleep.

We watch the alarm clock as the colon between the hours and
minutes flash. **11:59 PM.** We slowly push in to obscure the
date as the seconds past until **12:00 AM.**

BEEP, BEEP, BEEP! It's **6:07 AM** once again. Jake groans. He
went overboard last night and now has a raging hangover.

Jake goes to his closet to switch out of the pajamas he
usually wakes up in, only to find that they're on the floor.
He looks down at his own outfit, which is the same one he
wore last night. Odd.

Jake walks out of his room and down the stairs.

INT. JAKE'S KITCHEN - MORNING

He sees Robert making eggs, as per usual.

ROBERT

Good morning, J!

JAKE

Good morning, dad.

Jake fills up a glass of water and chugs all of it.

ROBERT
(while cooking, to Jake)
Oh, your mother called -

JAKE
Yeah, I know. She'll be here later
today. I've got to go, there's a
big project due.

Jake walks over to the living room to grab the map to construct his dialogue tree, but it's not there. Jake sees another map on the floor and grabs that, then steps out of the house.

Lucas bursts out of his room and makes his way down the stairs.

Once in the kitchen, Lucas groans loudly and puts his head down.

ROBERT
Not so fun the day after, is it?

LUCAS
I need some peace and quiet.

ROBERT
Oh, your mom will be here in about
thirty minutes! You can say hi to
her. Jake left really early.

Lucas nods his head, and puts in earbuds.

INT. MATH CLASSROOM - DAY

Jake walks into class, holding his head in his hands. Alex notices him walking in, but doesn't say anything. Jake sits down.

After a moment, he puts the newly constructed dialogue tree onto Alex's desk.

ALEX
What's this?
(notices the map)
Oh, God. Not this agin.

Jake suddenly looks at Alex, seemingly snapping out of his hangover.

JAKE
Again? What do you mean, again?

ALEX

Let me guess... you're in a time loop, and you know exactly what I'm going to say.

Jake stares at the map. Mrs. Hynes walks up behind him.

MRS. HYNES

Jake, I noticed you didn't turn in your project. It's due today, do you have it with you?

Jake's world is spiraling out of control. **What. Is. Happening?!** He looks up at Mrs. Hynes.

JAKE

Uh... I have to go.

Jake begins to stumble out of class. Mrs. Hynes and Alex look at each other.

MRS. HYNES

Is he alright?

ALEX

He partied a bit too hard last night; it made him a bit...
(makes the Cuckoo signal)

INT. SCHOOL HALLWAY - LATER

In a panic, Jake runs down the hallways before finding a water fountain. He turns it on and runs his face through the water.

The girl from before who dropped her books, Jenna, stops in her footsteps and stares at him.

JENNA

Are you alright?

JAKE

This?

(gestures to everything)

This isn't happening right now. You aren't supposed to be here right now! In -

(checks watch)

fifteen minutes, you're going to trip over your shoelaces and if I'm not in this hallway you'll bash your head on the floor. Not fun for you, right?

Jenna raises her eyebrow at him.

JENNA

Um, that happened yesterday. I got new shoes, see?

She points to her new **velcro** shoes. Jake manically laughs. He slides against the locker to the floor.

Jenna looks concerned and puts her books down.

JENNA

Look. I'm not sure what's going on in your life, but I really appreciated you helping me out yesterday.

She sits next to Jake.

JENNA

What's going on with you?

JAKE

(deep breath)

Alright, to make a long story short: I was stuck in a time loop. I can try to prove it to you later. Today, for the first time in... years? I'm out of it.

Jenna looks on with concern.

JAKE

(laughs)

You know, it's kinda funny! In this whole loop, I never learned your name.

Jenna thinks he's joking.

JENNA

(awkwardly)

Oh, it's Jenna. Jenna Lewis.

She offers her hand for a shake. Jake accepts it.

JAKE

Nice to finally meet you, Jenna.
I'm Jake.

The bell **RINGS**. Students begin to flood out of their classrooms, but Jenna and Jake stay together.

JENNA
You're joking, right?

Jake looks on with a confused stare.

JENNA
You're Jake Thompson. We literally
have a class together this ye-
(after seeing Jake shaking
his head)
Okay, whatever. You want some
wisdom? Say you were in a time
loop, like in -

JAKE
Groundhog Day.

JENNA
Groundhog Day.

Jenna smiles a bit at this.

JENNA
Right. Well, in a time loop, your
life is pointless. You can't make
any real change in your life
because every day resets. Now that
you're out of that loop, there's
real purpose to every decision you
make. I think that's worth
celebrating, right?

Jake nods his head. She checks her phone.

JENNA
I've gotta get to class.
(beat)
Again, thanks for helping me out
yesterday. I hope you get this
sorted out.

JAKE
Wow, thanks, Jenna! Sorry I forgot
your name.

Jenna laughs, gets up, and walks off to class. Jake doesn't
get up. He sees a shadow walk by him and looks up. It's Alex.
Jake stands up to walk over to his locker.

JAKE
Hey, Alex.

ALEX
(uninterested)
Hi, Jake.

JAKE

This is the first time in years
that I have no idea what to say to
you.

ALEX

Really? No way.

JAKE

You do believe me, right?

Alex closes his locker and looks at Jake.

ALEX

All that stuff you showed me
yesterday is... impossible. I
believe there's some truth to what
you think happened, but... a time
loop?

JAKE

I know it sounds insane but I SWEAR
that I can prove it to you.

ALEX

It's not the time loop that's the
issue.

JAKE

What is?

Alex shakes his head angrily.

ALEX

Do you seriously not have any idea
what you said to me last night?

JAKE

Alex, *last night* means a lot more
to me than it means to you. I've
had a thousand last nights and at
this point they all blur together.

ALEX

(exasperated)

Great. So you don't even remember
what you said.

JAKE

Wait, what did I say?

Jake looks genuinely forgetful. Alex looks at him with pity.

ALEX
You... forget it.

JAKE
Wait, I think I remember.
(beat, Alex looks hopeful)
Did I tell you about the lottery
numbers?

ALEX
(is disappointed)
What lottery numbers? Ugh. You're
ridiculous.

JAKE
(laughs)
Look, if it's something I said, can
you just tell me?

Jake isn't taking this seriously. Alex isn't impressed.

ALEX
You can't fuck with my feelings
like this, Jake. It's not fair to
me.

Jake suddenly realizes what he told Alex last night.

JAKE
Oh, shit.

ALEX
Right. I have to go.

Alex storms off. Jake feels defeated by this conversation.

After a beat, Jake begins to walk down the hallway, peeking
into various classrooms, until he sees a room adorned with
film posters.

INT. FILM CLASSROOM - LATER

Jake slowly cracks open the door of the film classroom. In
the classroom we see MRS. WASHINGTON (40s, seems way younger
than she is) teaching a class of uninterested students.

MRS. WASHINGTON
So, can anybody tell me why we
should shoot horizontally if we're
using our phones to film something?

She stands and waits for a second before sighing.

JAKE
(from behind her)
Because vertical video looks
ridiculous?

MRS. WASHINGTON
Oh, Jake! That's right! Thanks for
deciding to show up today.

Nobody seems to care. In the back of the classroom, we see Jenna looking up and taking notes. Mrs. Washington sits back down at her desk, and Jake sits next to her.

MRS. WASHINGTON
Oh, Jake. I have some bad news. You
didn't place at the festival.

JAKE
Yeah, I know.

MRS. WASHINGTON
Well, if you wanted to re-edit the
video, you could probably send it
off to another competition and see
if you could place! I know you put
a lot of work into that; I'm sorry.

JAKE
It's alright.

MRS. WASHINGTON
Also, since you weren't here
yesterday to sort through my
paperwork, I have a lot of stuff
for you to do.

Mrs. Washington grabs an enormous stack of various assignments and places them on his desk.

JAKE
(to self)
No wonder I stopped coming.
(mockingly)
Being a teacher's assistant will be
so easy!

While flipping through papers, he sees a shiny poster for a film competition that reads: "CENTRAL FLORIDA TEEN FILM SLAM." Jake shows it to Mrs. Washington.

JAKE
What's this?

MRS. WASHINGTON

When my students cared about the class, we'd win awards there every year! I wouldn't even bother applying now.

JAKE

How does it work?

MRS. WASHINGTON

You have seven days to plan, shoot, and edit a film with a certain prompt.

JAKE

What's the prompt?

MRS. WASHINGTON

Are you sure you want to apply? It's a lot of work!

JAKE

(overdramatic)

Yeah, might as well distract myself from the eternal pain of losing.

A beat.

MRS. WASHINGTON

Last time you worked alone, so maybe you should get a crew together this time. The prompt is on the website.

Mrs. Washington gets out of her chair and scans the room. Her students sit on their phones and screw around on their computers. Why are they even in this course?

That is, except for Jenna, who's diligently editing something on her computer.

MRS. WASHINGTON

(to Jake)

At least I have one other student who gives a shit.

(across the room,
searching)

Jenna! Where are you?

Jake looks up, and is surprised to see Jenna, who quickly hops out of her chair. He points to herself, confused.

MRS. WASHINGTON

Could you come here, please?

JAKE

Wait, why are you in this class?

Jenna raises her eyebrow at his hostility.

JENNA

What? I've been in here all year.

Jake looks confused.

JENNA

Remember? We worked on a project together.

Jake shakes his head.

JENNA

(sarcastically)

Oh... right. You were stuck in the time loop. What's up, Mrs. Washington?

MRS. WASHINGTON

I'm assembling a team to participate in an elite film competition!

Jenna looks down at the poster.

JENNA

The Central Florida Film Slam? Isn't that for middle schoolers?

MRS. WASHINGTON

They have a very distinguished jury.

JAKE

'Distinguished' meaning the local librarians.

MRS. WASHINGTON

Oh, hush. You two will need a third to round out the team.

Mrs. Washington randomly picks a name from the attendance sheet.

MRS. WASHINGTON

Sterling! Get over here.

STERLING KNIGHT (17, handsome, jocky and somewhat dumb looking) quickly looks up from his phone and walks over.

STERLING
What'd I do this time?

MRS. WASHINGTON
You're going to help Jake and Jenna
on this film project.
(to group)
I already told Jake here, but
you'll have seven days to make a
film with a certain prompt.

STERLING
I'm sorry, what is this? I don't
want to participate in this.

MRS. WASHINGTON
Mr. Knight, I am creating a 1,000
point assignment and will give you
a zero if you don't participate.

STERLING
Okay, geez. I'll do it.

JAKE
Oh, wait, we should probably check
the prompt before entering.

Jake Googles the film festival. On the page, a ghost flies up
and reveals the prompt: **"IN THE DARK."**

STERLING
So, is this, like, a horror thing?

JENNA
Looks like it.

JAKE
Before we start planning, could we
assign roles? I can write and
direct, Jenna can shoot and act,
and Sterling can be an assistant.
Does that work?

Jenna doesn't like that Jake is taking control immediately,
but reluctantly nods.

JAKE
Alright. I'll look for ideas
tonight and present them tomorrow.

INT. JAKE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Jake arrives home from school and throws his backpack across the living room.

JAKE
(loudly and sing-songy)
I'm hooome!

MELISSA (O.S.)
What's that, sweetie?

Just then: MELISSA (40s, long black hair, in business suit), Jake's mom, steps into the kitchen. Jake looks at her with shock, since he hasn't seen her since the loop.

JAKE
(in shock)
Mom!!!

Jake runs over to Melissa in tears. She doesn't quite understand why he's so happy to see her, but appreciates the love.

MELISSA
(caressing his shoulder)
It's great to see you again, J.

JAKE
(through tears, laughing)
You have no idea.

The two hold in their embrace for a moment. Robert and Lucas walk in from the living room.

ROBERT
What's all this ruckus?

JAKE
Dad! Lucas! Mom's home!

ROBERT
Yeah, buddy. I told you her flight was delayed.

Robert sees Jake's tears and looks at Melissa. She doesn't know why he's crying, either. He walks in and hugs the two of them.

INT. JAKE'S KITCHEN - THAT EVENING

After their touching reunion, the family all gets together for dinner. Each member has their own role in preparing the meal.

After finishing cooking, they sit down with a delicious looking dinner and begin to dig in.

MELISSA

So, Jake, what have you been up to recently?

Jake laughs, not even knowing where to begin. Melissa smiles at his laugh.

MELISSA

What's so funny?

Jake begins to laugh even harder.

JAKE

(through laughter)

It's just - haha - I don't even know where to begin.

Melissa looks to Robert and Lucas to find out what he's been up to.

LUCAS

What? This dude has been up to jack shit; I have no clue what he's talking about.

MELISSA

Lucas, language.

JAKE

Alright, if I told you guys that I was in a time loop and lived the same yesterday over and over again, would you believe me?

ROBERT

(while eating)

No.

Jake realizes the absurdity of the time loop situation and abandons trying to explain it.

JAKE

Okay, well, I've been digging into my own character and I'm now dedicated to being a better person.

ROBERT

(to Lucas)

See? It looks like you could learn
a thing or two from your brother.

Lucas looks up at Jake and scoffs. Melissa gives him a light smack.

MELISSA

I'm happy to hear that you've had a
productive few days, Jake.

The family continues to eat. They look happy.

INT. JAKE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT/DAY

Jake walks into his room with a smile on his face. He puts his backpack on his desk, and pulls out his computer, a charger, and plugs it in.

He grabs the dialogue tree out of his backpack and sets it down. Jake reminisces over the dialogue tree, looking through the various paths he was able to construct each morning.

He crumples it up and gets ready to toss it into his trash can, but ultimately decides to uncrumple it and lay it back out on his desk.

JAKE

(to self)

It doesn't hurt to keep a few
memories...

He turns his attention to his computer and goes back to the website where the film festival was announced. He pulls out a piece of paper and scribbles down ideas.

These ideas suck. He crosses them out and turns to YouTube to ideas. After typing in "Short film in the dark," he scrolls through a few videos before landing on David F. Sandberg's *Lights Out* short. Promising.

BEEP! BEEP! BEEP!

Jake's alarm goes off, jolting him awake. He looks at his computer, surrounded by the notes he took last night.

Jake gets out of bed.

JAKE

(to self)

Alright, Jake. Today is the first
day of the rest of your life.

He gets dressed, packs up his bag, and looks at the dialogue tree.

INT. FILM CLASSROOM - THE NEXT DAY

Jake walks into class and goes to his desk. Jenna is already sitting on the other side, ready to go. Sterling is on his phone.

JAKE

Guys, I have a great idea!

Jake pulls out his computer and flips it around to show them the short film. After a few moments:

JENNA

Why are you showing us this?

JAKE

This is what we're going to make!

STERLING

Why don't we come up with something original?

JENNA

(to Sterling's remark)

Yeah, I agree with him.

STERLING

(continuing thought)

Let's have ChatGPT write it for us.

JENNA

(frustrated)

Wait, no. That's worse.

JAKE

As long as we change things up a bit, it's not technically copying! Also, we only have four days so we don't have time to plan something else out.

Jenna doesn't look impressed. Sterling stares at his phone. On Jenna's disapproving stare:

JAKE

C'mon guys... we've got this!

Jake's optimism makes her smile.

JENNA
Whatever you say, Jake.

And with that, we're off!

BEGIN MONTAGE

As the upbeat JR JR song *As Time Goes* plays, we begin a montage of the next week of Jake's life:

Jake, Jenna, and Sterling going into the back closet of the film room and grabbing film supplies.

The trio trying on various costumes for their film and having a generally good time.

Jake runs home and hugs his parents.

The Thompson's all eat dinner together, laughing.

Jake stays up late studying for exams and working on storyboarding for the short film.

The next morning, Jake is a bit tired, but happy. **3 days left.**

Jake in math class the next morning, struggling to answer the question.

In film class, Jake in a group with Jenna and Sterling talking about ideas.

Back to dinner, with Jake just as jovial as he was the night before.

Jake stays up late again studying for math.

The next morning, Jake looks happy. **2 days left.**

The next day, Jake raises his hand in class and gets the question right. Alex is happy he got the question right.

Later that night at Sterling's house, Jake is working on filming his short film with Sterling and Jenna. Jake stands behind Sterling, who's filming, while Jenna peers around a corner as the leading actress. She looks scared.

Jake comes home too late for dinner, with the dishes already put up. It's fine, he goes upstairs and starts editing together the footage.

Jake wakes up and hops out of bed the next morning. **1 day left.**

In math class the next day, Jake pulls out his computer and works on editing instead of answering questions. Alex looks on in the distance.

Jake shows Jenna and Sterling the progress he's made.

That night, he stays up until midnight. We see the clock turn from **11:59 PM** to **12:00 AM** over his shoulder.

At the end of the song, Jake finishes editing the short film and after exporting his film, he clicks on a large "SUBMIT FILM" button. It's **2:57 AM**. He leans back in his chair, proud of his accomplishments.

INT. MATH CLASSROOM - THE NEXT WEEK

Jake struts into math class. Alex scribbles down notes.

JAKE
(sing-song-y)
Guess what happens today?

ALEX
(not having it)
What?

JAKE
(still happy)
Oh, don't give me that attitude.
Today the results for the a very
fancy film competition come out.
Guess who's going to be coming home
with a shiny trophy?

ALEX
Congrats.

Jake pauses. He gives a weird look to Alex, who continues taking notes.

JAKE
You know, it'd be nice if you
showed me some support whenever I
worked on a big project.

ALEX
(angrily, not looking
back)
Go to hell, Jake.

JAKE
Dude, what's your problem?

ALEX

(snaps)

Give me some fucking space! Holy shit, you are so insufferable sometimes.

Jake scoffs.

Alex quickly picks up his stuff and storms out of class.

JAKE

(loudly)

Alex, wait! I'm sorry!

Alex doesn't listen.

MRS. HYNES

Mr. Thompson, please keep your voice down.

JAKE

Can I go to the bathroom?

MRS. HYNES

(sternly)

No. Finish your work.

Jake sighs, and after a beat, goes back to his work.

INT. FILM CLASSROOM - LATER

Jake walks into class, and sees Sterling and Jenna sitting at his desk. They look like they've just gotten some bad news.

JAKE

What's wrong, guys?

MRS. WASHINGTON

Oh, Jake. Come here.

Mrs. Washington pulls Jake aside.

MRS. WASHINGTON

I just want to preface this with saying that I loved the work that you put together.

Jake looks confused.

JAKE

Uh, okay?

MRS. WASHINGTON
But, it didn't place at the
festival.

JAKE
What do you mean it didn't place?
We didn't even get into the top
three?

Mrs. Washington nods. Jake stares forward, devastated. After a beat, he walks to his desk and sits down. Jenna goes to comfort him, but he doesn't react.

JENNA
Look, this isn't all bad! We can re-
edit it for a future competition
and try again.

Jake sighs and puts his head in his hands.

INT. JAKE'S HOUSE - EVENING

Jake steps in the house and gives his mother a big, sad hug. He doesn't say anything to her.

At dinner, the family eats and while Robert, Lucas, and Melissa are talking, Jake keeps his eyes focused on the food.

In his bedroom, Jake slowly walks in and sits on his laptop. He pulls out a large math textbook and begins to study.

After writing down a few notes, he looks over at the dialogue tree, resting on his desk. He picks it up and covers his mouth with it before letting out a muffled **SCREAM**. He rips the map up and scatters the pieces on his desk.

After destroying the dialogue tree, he rests for a second before picking up his pencil and returning to studying.

A little bit after midnight, Jake goes to bed.

BEGIN MONTAGE

A new cycle begins in Jake's life, consisting of the exact same routine.

NOTE: In each new scene, we match cut on Jake's bored/depressed face.

In the morning, Jake drives to school.

In class, Jake stares forward and silently takes notes.

In DVP, he watches Mrs. Washington as she teaches to a class of uninterested students.

After school, Jake walks into the house and eats dinner with his family.

He studies before going to bed late.

He waves to Alex in the hallway, who doesn't seem to notice him.

Each day, Jake looks a bit more tired.

Jake wakes up. He sits in math. Alex talks to other friends. He longingly looks forward in his film class. He eats dinner without saying a word.

This cycle repeats several times. Jake looks increasingly jaded and depressed as the cuts grow quicker.

One night, Jake skips the studying and scrolls through his phone instead. He opens up Instagram and swipes through photos of his friends, liking their photos that seem much more interesting than his life.

He sees a photo of Alex hanging out with a group of new friends. Jake turns off his phone and goes to bed.

INT. FILM CLASSROOM - THE NEXT DAY

Jake looks jaded, as usual, as Mrs. Washington teaches.

MRS. WASHINGTON

(droning on)

So, in essence, the tighter the aperture is, the more stuff will be in focus of the camera... which matters why?

She desperately looks around for an answer. Upon seeing nobody:

MRS. WASHINGTON

(to self)

Remind me why I left ESPN for this?

Jake quietly chuckles at her comment. The bell RINGS. While packing up his stuff, Sterling walks up to his desk.

STERLING

Hey, Jake. I'm throwing tonight. You should come.

JAKE
(scratching neck)
I don't know.

STERLING
Dude! Snap out of this attitude! I know you're upset about losing this competition but that's no reason to be such a downer.

JAKE
(mumbles)
That's not what it's about...

STERLING
Then what is it?
(beat)
Anyways, I have **all** the drinks you could want. Please, I am BEGGING you to get shit faced with me tonight.

Mrs. Washington raises her eyebrow at this comment.

MRS. WASHINGTON
I'm going to pretend I didn't hear that.

STERLING
You've been looking a bit upset, too, Mrs. Washington. Wanna come and get a few brewskis with us?

MRS. WASHINGTON
(not having it, but not in a mean way)
Oh get the hell out, Sterling.

She points the two out of the room and they quickly leave.

STERLING
(while leaving)
So, are you coming?

Jake sighs, thinking it over.

JAKE
(giving in)
Uh... sure, I guess.

STERLING
Great! See you there!
(walks away then turns back)
(MORE)

STERLING (CONT'D)

Oh, and don't forget to wear all
neon!

Jake cracks a smile.

I/E. STERLING'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Jake walks up to Sterling's lawn, dressed in a bright neon outfit. He looks like a little kid dressing himself.

JAKE

(to self)

I look ridiculous.

He takes a deep breath and walks into the house. The peace of the night is interrupted by the loud music and bright colors streaming from inside the house.

Once inside, Jake takes a moment to adjust to the loudness of it all. Teenagers flood the halls and sway back and forth in the living room in a sea of chaos.

Sterling sees Jake standing by himself and walks over to dap him up. He's very drunk.

STERLING

You made it!

JAKE

(unenthusiastic)

Yeah. Thanks for hosting.

Sterling hands him a handle of vodka that was sitting on a little table next to him.

STERLING

Drink this! Talk to me after you've
had a few shots!

JAKE

(reluctantly)

Alright.

Sterling walks away. Jake awkwardly sits in the corner. He puts the handle down and pours a shot, downing it by himself.
Yuck.

After looking into the crowd and seeing how happy everybody looks, he takes the handle into Sterling's kitchen and gets a large plastic cup. He pours far too much vodka into the cup and mixes it with equal parts lemonade.

Jake peers into the monstrous concoction he's just made, and begins to **chug**. He slams the cup down after he's finished.

JAKE
(to self)
And... we're off.

He looks down at his watch.

MATCH CUT TO:

15 minutes later. Jake decides to get in on the action and moves to the living room. He joins the crowd of dancing drunk teenagers and begins to dance.

We slow down and for the first time in a while, Jake looks completely happy. It's almost a euphoric moment for him.

After a moment, Jake sees Jenna drinking in the corner. He stumbles out to her.

JAKE
(loudly)
Hey, Jenna!

JENNA
Oh, hey Jake! How are you?!

The noise around them is too loud for either of them to hear. Jake gestures to his ear that he can't hear her.

JAKE
(shouting)
What?

JENNA
I said 'how are you?!'

He shakes his head once again.

JAKE
I can't hear you! Follow me!

The two walk out to the backyard.

EXT. STERLING'S BACKYARD - CONTINUOUS

Jake and Jenna stumble on their way to grab seats and look out toward the lake. Jake isn't quite as drunk as he was before but it's safe to say neither one is level headed.

JAKE

This -
(gesturing to the lake)
This is nice.

Jenna nods her head in agreement. They sit for a beat.

JAKE

So, what's going on with you? Any
new lovers in your life?

Yeah, right. Jenna laughs to herself.

JENNA

You know, I thought that by senior
I'd have somebody in my life. But
for now...

JAKE

..you're bitchless.

JENNA

(laughs)
Sure, that's one way of putting it.

Another beat.

JAKE

Seriously, though, are there are
romantic contenders in your life?

Jenna is hesitant to reveal information this early.

JAKE

(seeing her hesitation)
I get it. Don't tell me if you
aren't comfortable.

JENNA

It's not like that. The last time I
told somebody I had a crush on, the
whole school knew about it in a
week.

Jake mimics a key locking his mouth.

JENNA

(checks around her)
Alright, you have to promise to
keep it a secret.

JAKE

Alright. Promise.

The two share a pinky promise.

JENNA
Okay, so do you know Alex
Hernandez?

JAKE
(laughs loudly)
Oh... I know Alex. Is that a joke?

Jenna shakes her head.

JAKE
We're literally best friends; I've
known him since I was, like, eight.
Well, I guess I'm not his best
friend anymore. What about him?
(realizing)
Wait, you have a crush on him?

JENNA
Well, he's cute is all, and I've
been thinking about asking him out.

Jake can't let this happen. Even though his relationship is
strained with Alex, Jake has to be with Alex. Somehow. He
thinks of a lie.

JAKE
Awe, I'm sure he'd appreciate that
but... he definitely isn't into
you.

JENNA
(hurt)
Oh... really? Why not?

JAKE
I mean, he isn't into girls.
He's...

JENNA
Oh!
(disappointed)
Oh.

JAKE
Yeah.

Jenna frowns.

JENNA
Truer words have not been spoken.

The two laugh and look at each other. After a beat:

JENNA

(upset)

Well, I'm going to get back to the party.

JAKE

Good talk, Jenna. Oh, and Alex he's not out yet... so don't -

JENNA

Oh God, I would never. Don't worry.

Jake gives a thumbs up. Jenna struggles to get up for a second and walks back into the house. Jake looks off and ponders his actions. He smiles slightly.

INT. JAKE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Jake stumbles into the house and tries to quietly move up to his room. From the living room:

MELISSA

Jake? Is that you?

JAKE

(drunk)

Uh... no?

Shit. Jake facepalms. He grabs onto something to hold his balance. Melissa walks into the hallway, while Robert stays behind.

JAKE

I mean, yes!

MELISSA

It's almost two in the morning, where on Earth were you?

JAKE

I was at Sterling's house. We were, uh, working on a project.

Melissa gets up and walks into the hallway that Jake is in. He tries to stand up straight but continually sways as he fights the effect of alcohol.

MELISSA

(to Robert)

Honey! Jake's drunk.

ROBERT

Good for him! Make sure he drinks a lot of water so he avoids a hangover!

Jake smiles at his dad's support. Melissa frowns. The two lock eyes, and Jake starts to cackle, breaking his mom's frown.

MELISSA

Alright, you're safe tonight, J. Get up to your bed and let's not make this a habit! Senioritis will beat your ass..

Jake nods and makes his way upstairs.

INT. JAKE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT / MORNING

After walking into his room, Jake plops down into his chair and spins around. He gets up, but the combination of his inebriation and the dizziness makes him fall flat on his face. He laughs to himself.

JAKE

(drawn out)
I feel good.

Jake falls asleep on the floor.

The next morning, Jake gets himself off the floor. He yawns and slogs to get his clothes on. He's clearly hungover, groaning as he slowly gets ready.

INT. JAKE'S KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS

Jake walks down the stairs and plops himself at the table. Melissa and Robert are busy in the kitchen, making food for the family. Lucas is sitting on his phone at the table, as per usual. Jake puts his head down and moans at his pain.

MELISSA

Rough night, huh?

Jake gives a muffled "yeah."

LUCAS

Hah! You're hungover.

Robert hands Jake an ice-cold glass of water.

ROBERT

Drink as much as you can right now
and throughout the day to alleviate
the symptoms.

Jake reluctantly pulls his head up and starts to sip at the water.

JAKE

Thanks, dad.

Robert and Melissa put plates down for everybody, and begin to eat.

MELISSA

Eat up!

JAKE

Ugh -- why is it so bright in here?

Melissa looks around. She closes one of the curtains

LUCAS

Since y'all are so chill with Jake
getting drunk whenever he wants,
can I have some friends here to
drink this weekend?

MELISSA

(stern)

Absolutely not!

LUCAS

That's not fair! Dad let me go out
to a party a few weeks ago.

Robert widens his eyes to Lucas, signaling that it was supposed to be a secret.

MELISSA

Oh... is that true?

Melissa turns with a suspicious glance to Robert, who puts his hands up like he's innocent.

JAKE

Wait, yeah, why are you guys so
fine with me drinking?

ROBERT

It's senior year! That's when I
started drinking, too.

(MORE)

ROBERT (CONT'D)

You've already gotten your applications in, so there's not much that could change. Speaking of, when do you hear back from your schools?

Jake hasn't thought of college applications since before the loop.

JAKE

Uh, honestly... I forgot what college I even I applied to. I think I sent something in to Florida and FSU but I'm not sure if I applied anywhere out of state.

MELISSA

Let's hope that you submitted an application at all! You've been so all over the place recently.

JAKE

Yeah. I know.

MELISSA

Can you drop Lucas off at cross country practice?

JAKE

Ugh -- no.

MELISSA

(angrily)
What's that?

JAKE

(backing down)
I meant yes! This hangover's got me all confused.

Jake goes back to eating his food, then grabs his stuff and walks out the door with Lucas.

INT. JAKE'S CAR - CONTINUOUS

While driving, Jake cranks up the music while Lucas stays on his phone. Jake is bored of driving and looks over to Lucas for conversation. He turns down the music.

JAKE

So... what's going on in your life, Lucas?

Lucas is confused as to why Jake's asking him this.

LUCAS
Huh? My life?

JAKE
Yeah.

LUCAS
Why do you care?

JAKE
(scoffs)
Uh, because I'm your brother?

LUCAS
I dunno.

JAKE
'I dunno'? You're ridiculous.

Lucas looks up from his phone and thinks long and hard about what's going on.

LUCAS
I've been thinking about joining
film club, but I don't really know
where to start.

JAKE
Oh, I'm actually an officer, did
you want me to reach out to Mrs.
Washington to get you in?

LUCAS
Wait, could you really do that?

JAKE
Of course!
(beat)
Come to think of it, I haven't been
to a meeting in a while.

LUCAS
Oh.

JAKE
Don't worry! I could get you in,
probably.

LUCAS
Thanks!

Jake forces a smile. He still feels like shit.

He eventually pulls the car to a stop at a park. Lucas gets out and jogs over to a group of RUNNERS, who are getting ready to leave.

INT. JAKE'S BEDROOM - DAY/NIGHT

Jake walks into his bedroom. We see multiple copies of him living out the weekend.

One sits on the computer, watching a movie, occasionally scrolling through his phone instead of paying attention.

Another sits on his Xbox, playing games with his friends.

A third sits in bed, playing on his phone.

Multiple copies pace around the room, tossing a ball up and down.

The times of day change quickly in the window.

The camera eventually moves to his bed, and we see a match cut to:

6:37 AM. BEEP! BEEP! BEEP!

Jake GROANS and gets up.

I/E. SCHOOL / MATH CLASSROOM / FILM CLASSROOM - DAY

Jake pulls into his parking spot and looks at the school ahead of him.

After some internal debate, he gets out and walks in.

Jake walks into math class and sits down. Alex is sitting behind him.

JAKE

Hey, Alex.

Alex ignores him, turns around, and starts talking to one of his friends.

Mrs. Hynes begins teaching about integrals and derivatives, and Jake puts his head down.

Later, Jake walks into film class and is handed an enormous stack of papers by Mrs. Washington.

MRS. WASHINGTON
Hey, Jake. Can you get these sorted
for me by the end of class?

Jake looks at the size of the stack.

JAKE
Uh... sure.

MRS. WASHINGTON
Great, thanks!

Jake gets to work sorting through the series of papers,
putting them into different piles based on their grades.

After sorting papers for a bit, Sterling walks up to Jake.

STERLING
Yo, Jake! My parents are leaving on
Friday for a party, ready to run it
back?

JAKE
Seriously? How many parties can one
man have?

Sterling looks forward with a stupid stare.

STERLING
Is that a serious question?

JAKE
Yeah.

The gears in Sterling's head start to crank really hard. He
squints hard at Jake, before coming to the decision that he's
making a joke.

STERLING
(laughs)
Good one! I'll see you then.

The bell RINGS.

INT. JAKE'S KITCHEN - NIGHT

The Thompsons all eat Chinese takeout around their table.
Robert slurps up some soup noisily.

JAKE
(while on phone)
Oh, I forgot to tell you guys, I'm
going to Sterling's tonight.

Robert looks up from his soup and exchanges a concerned look
with Melissa.

MELISSA
Again? Weren't you just there last
weekend?

JAKE
Yeah.

ROBERT
I know we're usually pretty
accepting, but come on.

JAKE
(still on phone)
Relax, dad. I'm working on a film
project, not getting drunk. I'm not
an alcoholic.

LUCAS
Sure...

Jake stares down Lucas. Lucas backs down. Jake backs out of
his seat.

JAKE
Alright, I'm going to head out now.

MELISSA
Already?

JAKE
Yup. Gotta get going.

Melissa looks sad to see her son going, but Jake doesn't look
back.

INT. STERLING'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Jake walks into the house. As per usual, it's filled to the
brim with high school kids. Sterling stumbles over to Jake
with a Solo cup full of some sort of liquid.

Jake smiles at the drunkenness of his friend. He looks into
the cup and shrugs. Bottoms up!

He chugs down the drink and throws the cup to the ground, navigating his way to the center.

Jake checks his phone. On it -- multiple texts to Alex "**Hey, how are you?**", "**wanna hang later?**", "**what's up?**". All ignored. He puts his phone up.

Jake dances in the center of the dance floor for a bit.

Amongst the crowd he sees Alex, vibing by himself. The alcohol coursing through Jake's veins gets the best of him. He walks over to Alex.

JAKE
(loudly, drunk)
Hey, Alex!

ALEX
(uninterested)
Hey, Jake.

JAKE
Why are you here?

Alex doesn't make eye contact with Jake.

ALEX
Why do you care? Why are you here?

JAKE
I'm here... to confront you for being a shitty friend.

ALEX
Jake, go home. You're drunk.

Alex starts to walk away, but Jake grabs him.

JAKE
(stumbling over words)
No, **you** need to leave. Sterling says that, uh, all losers need to... to leave.

Alex gives a profound eye roll and stares at Jake.

ALEX
Is this how you handle things? Are you this pathetic that as soon as you face any sort of problem you devolve into... this?

He gestures to Jake, who's inebriation has him slightly wobbling while trying to maintain serious eye contact.

ALEX

I mean, you lose one film competition and this is how you cope with it? Jake, come on. Look at what you've become.

JAKE

At least I care about something in my life. You're passionless.

Jake laughs maniacally.

JAKE (CONT'D)

You are so complacent with doing nothing. I pity you.

Alex sits with a straight face and collects his thoughts for a beat.

ALEX

Remember how you told me you were stuck in that time loop or whatever?

Jake nods.

ALEX

Right. Did you learn absolutely nothing from that? Let me assume that you're not making up some psychotic lie and that you were actually living the same day repeatedly.

JAKE

It's not a lie.
(smugly)
Go on.

ALEX

(sighs)

How the hell did you get out? You are one of the shittiest friends I know, and even after God himself told you to change by putting you in that loop, you left without making any real change.

JAKE

I actually made a lot -

ALEX

(snaps)

Don't interrupt me!
(MORE)

ALEX (CONT'D)

(backing out)

You know what? I'm not even going to bother. You don't deserve my time.

Alex storms off. Jake stares at the wall, trying to regain some sort of sobriety. After standing still for a moment, he turns around and begins to storm out the house.

On the way out, Jake grabs his car keys and walks to his car.

I/E. JAKE'S CAR - CONTINUOUS

Jake turns on the engine and starts blasting some music. He reaches for something in the back seat, but accidentally puts the car into neutral. It starts to roll backwards.

Moments before, inside the cop car:

COP #1

(speaking into radio)

Pulling into Tangerine Place,
checking out this noise complaint.

The car continues to pull forward before suddenly stopping. Inches in front of them, Jake's car rolls all the way back across the street and **CRASHES** into another car.

Two COPS look at each other.

COP #1

What the hell?

COP #2

From the party, maybe?

They flip on the siren.

INT. JAIL - NIGHT

FLASH!

Jake gets his mugshot taken at his local jail.

Later in a cell, Jake sits with a two other inmates, who look hardened by their time in prison. One is MARCO, and the other FRANKLIN. Both are in their late 30s or 40s, and look hardened by previous times spent in jail. They speak gruffly. There's a strong juxtaposition between Jake and the others.

MARCO

What are you in for?

JAKE
 (hesitant)
 Uh - I got wasted and drove into a pole.

FRANKLIN
 Drunk driving? That's a huge no-no.
 Got my buddy in for thirty-five years.

JAKE
 (suddenly scared)
 thirty-five years?! What?!

Franklin nods his head.

MARCO
 Oh, don't let Franklin scare ya.
 His bud was also smuggling drugs 'cross the border.

JAKE
 (relieved)
 Oh. Why wouldn't you tell me that?

Franklin shrugs. They sit there for a moment. Jake looks around the cold interior of his cell.

JAKE
 Well, what are y'all in here for?

FRANKLIN	MARCO
None of your business.	Bank robbery.

JAKE
 Wait, y'all were the ones robbing
 the Bank of America off of Corrine?

Marco and Franklin side eye each other. After a moment:

MARCO
 Joking! Franklin over here thought
 it'd be a good idea to hit a police
 officer.

Franklin looks angry and Marco and smacks him.

FRANKLIN
 You were the one who ran the red
 light! I was protecting you from
 that asshole cop.

Marco takes the hits and accepts that it's his fault.

MARCO

Relax. My lawyer friend said that if I say I was trying to swat a bug and accidentally hit him, I would be fine.

FRANKLIN

What?! You need a better lawyer.

MARCO

Fine, but how did scrawny over here know about it?

JAKE

Y'all are familiar with *Groundhog Day*, right?

Franklin shakes his head.

JAKE

Right. Well, the premise is that this total loser gets stuck in a time loop where he repeats the same day over and over. At one point, he sees when a bank truck is doing a delivery and uses that window to take the bag of money for the day. That's what I was doing with y'all.

FRANKLIN

(sarcastically)

Oh, sure. How did you actually find out?

JAKE

I know it doesn't make sense, but that's the truth.

While Franklin looks understandably confused by this, Marco looks on with understanding.

MARCO

Wait, I understand. So you were stuck in this loop thingy?

Jake is surprised that Marco understands his situation.

JAKE

(cautiously)

Yeah...

MARCO

Why?

JAKE
I'm sorry?

MARCO
Why were you stuck in this loop?

JAKE
I'm not sure. I spent a lot of time
trying to figure out but it
wouldn't work.

MARCO
Well, in *Groundhog Day*, Phil can't
get out until he accepts his fate
and becomes a better person. One of
the things that helps him get there
is the girl - what's her name?

Jake looks on in astonishment at Marco's knowledge of
Groundhog Day (comparatively to Franklin's total lack of
understanding) and his understanding of his situation.

JAKE
(boggled)
Uh, Rita.

MARCO
Right. Once Phil falls in love with
Rita, he escapes the loop. Did that
happen to you?

JAKE
Now that you mention it, the last
thing that happened was I confessed
my love to my best friend.

MARCO
Well, there you have it! What
happened to her?

JAKE
'She' is a 'he' and I don't think
he's into dudes.

MARCO
Oh! That's fine! Franklin's also...
you know.

JAKE
Really?

Jake laughs. Franklin, who wasn't paying much attention
either now perks up.

FRANKLIN

Sorry, what's Marco telling you now?

MARCO

(playfully)

We're just talking about how much of a fruit you are!

FRANKLIN

(gruffly)

Funny.

MARCO

Also, scrawny here has a crush on his best friend and he doesn't like him back.

FRANKLIN

(mockingly)

Oh, boo-hoo. If I had a dollar for every time I'd gotten rejected by another guy I wouldn't have had to rob that bank in the first place.

JAKE

(sarcastically)

Thanks, Franklin. You're such a bundle of sunshine, I wonder how you aren't taken yet.

The three sit for a moment.

MARCO

Have you tried talking to your friend since you left your little loop?

JAKE

Yeah. We just didn't click.

FRANKLIN

If I had sat around my entire life without going after the people I love, I wouldn't be with the love of my life.

Franklin scoots over and gives Marco a kiss on the cheek. It's cute. Jake is shocked. Marco looks at Jake's reaction.

MARCO

What? Do you have a problem with this?

JAKE

Oh shut up. You two are ridiculous.

Jake laughs, and the other two join in. A guard walks from the hallway.

GUARD

Thompson! You're free to go.

JAKE

Really?

The guard starts unlocking the cell and opens it up. Jake looks around and gets up.

JAKE

(to Marco and Franklin)

Thanks for your advice, guys.

MARCO

Of course. Now get the hell out of here! If we see you again...

Franklin punches into his fist. He looks serious and a little playful about it. Jake awkwardly smiles. He waves and walks down the hallway.

As Jake makes his way to the front, he sees Alex waiting in the lobby for him. Jake quickly stops.

JAKE

(to guard)

Wait, who made my bail?

GUARD

They did.

The guard points to a VERY ANGRY Melissa and Robert.

JAKE

Oh... shit.

The guard walks away. The two cross their arms. Jake puts his hands in his pockets.

JAKE

(slow and awkwardly)

What's up, guys?

INT. MELISSA'S CAR - CONTINUOUS

Jake sits in the back of his mom's car. Robert sits in the passenger side seat. After a beat:

JAKE
I can explain, guys -

MELISSA
(curt)
I **don't** want to hear it.

Jake awkwardly twiddles his thumbs. Another beat.

MELISSA
Jail?! I mean - after everything we've done for you? Was it not enough to send you to a good school and to raise you in a good house? What are you supposed to do for college now? All of our years of effort - GONE. It's gone!
(weak laugh)
What did we do wrong, Jake? Why did you think this was a good decision? Should we have been stricter and forced you to stay home every night? We gave you everything you wanted and you still blew it! What a waste. What a waste!

Melissa groans. Robert rubs her shoulder.

ROBERT
(quietly to Melissa)
Sweetheart, calm down. It seems like it was an accident, at least he wasn't trying to drive the car.

MELISSA
(quietly back, angrily)
This wouldn't have happened if **you** didn't let him go out all the time.

ROBERT
Shh... would you rather have a child who resents us or one who makes a few mistakes?

Melissa sighs; Robert's words helped her. Jake stares forward, sadly.

INT. JAKE'S HOUSE - LATER

With his head held low, Jake trudges into his house. He sees his parents whispering about something - definitely him - at the kitchen table. Melissa looks over and sees Jake, ending the conversation and walking over to him.

MELISSA
(concerned)
Jake...

JAKE
(dismissive)
I know... I know!

Jake tries walking straight to his room, but she stops him.

MELISSA
(snapping)
After what you've put me through
tonight, Jake, don't you DARE walk
past me. I am your mother.

JAKE
(spiraling)
I'm sorry, okay! I'm a **fuck-up**!
What else can I say? I messed up.
I'm sorry! Is that what you want to
hear? It doesn't even matter if
that's what you wanted to hear,
because no matter what I tell you,
you will never believe that my life
has been destroyed because of
something that nobody else has
experienced before. You can only
judge me for what -

After seeing Jake's disarray, Melissa pulls him in for a
tight hug, which gets him to stop.

MELISSA
(comforting)
Jake... stop it. I'm sorry. Every
teenager -
(quietly)
"fucks up" -
(normally)
At least once. Granted, they don't
usually go to jail, but we'll
figure this out together.

Robert joins in for the hug. Jake hasn't gotten this sort of
physical attention in a long time. He needed it.

After a beat:

MELISSA
(to Jake)
Alright, off to bed with you.

JAKE

Wait, that's it? No grounding, I get to keep my phone?

ROBERT

We've decided to let you off the hook for it this **once**. Don't tell your brother.

Jake is happy that they haven't decided to punish him.

JAKE

I love you, guys.

ROBERT

We love you, too.

Jake walks up to his room.

I/E. JAKE'S BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

In his room, Jake walks over to his desk and plops himself into his chair. After spinning around, he looks at the scattered pieces of the dialogue tree he destroyed earlier on top of his desk.

One of the many pieces has a box labeled with "confess my love". He connects it to another piece of the map that has a line with a question mark above it.

After putting the two pieces together, Jake sighs and puts his head down.

After a beat, he picks his head up and fetches a piece of lined paper from his backpack and starts writing on it.

"Alex," he inscribes at the top. He ponders what to right next.

Nope. Jake crumples up the paper and throws it away. He puts his pencil down and walks over to his bed.

Jake stares at his ceiling, pondering what he could do differently.

On his phone, Jake views a completed version of one of his old films. Jake and Alex, here a few years younger, are messing around in a low-quality, yet fun looking murder mystery.

Jake smiles while watching the two poorly act. He turns off his phone and goes to bed.

INT. FILM CLASSROOM - THE NEXT DAY

Jake stares distantly across the room, thinking about something.

Jenna paces back and forth, building up the courage to say something to Jake. She confidently walks up to him. He continues staring off.

JENNA

Mrs. Washington said that a new competition was opening up, and I want to be the director this time.

JAKE

Mhm.

JENNA

What? Jake, did you hear me?

JAKE

Yeah.

Jenna shakes her head in frustration at Jake's lack of attention.

JENNA

I want to be the director of our next film. Are you okay with that?

Jake tilts his head up at Jenna.

JAKE

Yeah.

Jenna stands there, looking at Jake. After determining that he's serious, she begins to walk away. Before taking a few steps, she turns back around and walks up to him.

JENNA

What, no arguing? Since when are you so willing to give up the role as director?

JAKE

Jenna, have you ever experienced a singular event in your life that makes you rethink everything you've done and everything you will do?

Jenna squints her eyes in concern.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Well, that happened to me last night when I was in jail.

JENNA

Arrested?!

JAKE

Doesn't matter. How should I tell Alex I'm in love with him?

Jenna has no idea what's happening.

JENNA

What the hell are you talking about?

Jenna looks back to Jake. She slowly grabs a chair and sits next to him.

JENNA

Well, are you two even on speaking terms again? I thought y'all were having a rough time.

JAKE

That's what I'm trying to fix, Jenna! Help me out here.

Jenna stares in deep thought for a second. She pulls out a completed script for her short film from her backpack. She flips through it quickly, takes a pen out, and writes something down.

JENNA

I've already written the script. It's a love story. I can cast you two as actors in it. That way, you can reconnect with him under the guise of just making a short film.

JAKE

Wait, you'd do that for me?
(beat, narrows eyes
suspiciously)
Why?

Jenna sighs.

JENNA

Clearly, you two have a bond that I could never match. I'll find somebody someday, but for now let's get you your man.

Jake smiles goofily and nods his head. Jenna rolls her eyes, wanting him to take it seriously.

JENNA
(semi-seriously)
Stop that.

He continues smiling. After a second, Jake stretches his arms out and gives Jenna a big hug. It's cute.

JAKE
Thank you, thank you, thank you!

JENNA
Yeah, yeah. Thank me when we get
this award!

BEGIN MONTAGE

Jake walks into his bedroom, satisfied with the day he's had.

He approaches his desk, opens his computer, and looks at his grades. **Not good.** C's and D's litter the page. Jake **sighs**, and gets to work on studying.

A printer **whirs**, printing out stacks of study packets for Jake's classes. He picks up the papers, goes to his desk, and lays them down.

He looks at the first question and... **shit.** He has no clue where to even start. He googles, "how to factor binomials."

In math class, Jake sits up straight and focuses on the board, taking notes along the way.

After school, Jake walks through the hallways with Lucas. Right outside of his film class is a poster that says "FILM CLUB MEETING HERE." The two step in.

A group of students sit while Mrs. Washington finishes a short presentation.

The students separate into groups. Jake brings Lucas up to the podium.

JAKE
This is my little brother, Lucas.

MRS. WASHINGTON
Oh, I remember! You were telling me
about him. Hi, Lucas!

LUCAS

Hi!

JAKE

I know he hasn't been to any of the meetings, and he didn't watch the films for this week, but would he be able to participate?

MRS. WASHINGTON

Of course.

(to Lucas)

Why don't you join him in the first group?

Lucas walks off.

At home, Jake has dinner with his family. Lucas looks happy, and Jake smiles at his brother's happiness.

In his bedroom, Jake looks back at his problems. This time, he's not entirely stumped. He looks proud of himself as he writes down an answer. He's able to get the second one, too.

When he sees the third, he has no clue. He googles, "how to factor **trinomials**."

In math the next day, he takes more notes.

In film class, Jake holds a script in front of his face and practices lines from Jenna's script.

JAKE

(reading)

I knew it was you, you rotten bastard! You're going to rot in jail.

(squints at script)

What is this? Did you do rewrites?

Jenna nods her head.

JAKE

Well, is it still romantic?

JENNA

Of course!

JAKE

(doesn't trust her)

Okay...

At the dinner table, Jake reads the script while the family is eating. He looks really into it.

In his room, Jake paces around the room while practicing the script. He leans in for a kiss in the air. His alarm goes off.

He walks to the desk, gets on his computer, and goes back to studying.

In math class, he gets a paper back: **A**. He smiles at his accomplishment.

END MONTAGE

INT. SCHOOL HALLWAY - DAY

In the hallway outside of film class, he looks confident as he practices lines from his script in front of Jenna and Sterling.

JAKE

(boldly)

I knew you were innocent from the moment I met you. Now that you're free, I can finally say... I love you.

STERLING

(stilted, reading off script)

I love you too, Joel. Give me a kiss!

Jake approaches Sterling and goes in for a kiss. Sterling is afraid that he'll actually kiss him.

JENNA

And... cut! Jake, you aren't actually kissing Sterling.

JAKE

I knew that!

Jake winks at Sterling.

STERLING

Ew. Save that for Alex.

JENNA

I think it's looking good! Great work, Jake.

JAKE

Has Alex been practicing this on his own?

JENNA

I don't know. I told him to, but nobody ever listens to me. Anyways, we'll meet at the stage after school and try to get it all done. Guys, please be prepared! I don't want to stay until midnight shooting.

JAKE

Got it.

INT. SCHOOL AUDITORIUM - AFTERNOON

Jake, Jenna, and Sterling stand on the stage of a large auditorium. On the set, Sterling stands behind the camera and has a boom mic, while Jenna has a director's chair that she's sitting on.

In lieu of actual set pieces, the set is comprised of a large green screen. Jake has a prison warden outfit on, and has a baton in his hand.

JAKE

(gesturing to green screen)

What's up with all this?

JENNA

Well, we were planning on building out this intricate jail set, but time constraints came up and I couldn't find anybody to help me.

JAKE

This looks nothing like jail. Trust me, I'd know.

JENNA

This is the fifth time you've mentioned jail. You shouldn't be bragging about it. We'll just green screen the jail later and it'll look real.

STERLING

(laughs)

Fix it in post, right?

Across the auditorium, the doors open. Dressed in a prisoner's uniform is Alex, looking down at his script.

ALEX
(shouting across
auditorium while walking)
Sorry I'm a bit late, it took me
longer than I thought to get dre-

Alex stops talking after looking up at Jake.

ALEX
(to Jenna)
What's he doing here?

JENNA
Oh, it turns out Sterling doesn't
know how to act, so we brought in
Jake to do it instead!

JAKE
(whispering to Jenna)
Wait, he didn't know I would be
doing this?

JENNA
(to Jake)
Surprise! I thought it'd be good
for the romantic tension on screen.

JAKE
(whispering)
You're ridiculous.
(to Alex)
Hey, Alex!

Alex hops onto the stage. He looks a little bit upset.

ALEX
What's up with all the green
screen?

JENNA
Budget issues.

ALEX
That's gonna make it hard to act.

JAKE
(excitedly)
That's what I was saying!

Alex eyes Jake, signaling him to *shut up*. Jake continues smiling.

JENNA
 Don't worry guys! If all goes
 right, we should be out of here by
 3:00.

A slow dolly to a clock. 1:55 turns into...

MATCH CUT TO:

5:03. Leaning against the green screen are a clearly
 exhausted Jake and Alex. Jenna leans all the way forward in
 her chair.

JENNA
 (exasperated)
 And... cut!

STERLING
 (overjoyed)
 We did it!

JAKE
 Wait, that's it?

Jake and Alex look eager to be completed. They're
 disappointed to hear:

JENNA
 Not so fast. We have one more scene
 to shoot. The climax.

Jake and Alex throw their hands up.

JENNA
 I want to get out of here as much
 as y'all, but come on! This is what
 we've been building to! Let's get
 this on the first take and we'll be
 done.

ALEX
 (gesturing to Jake)
 Tell this asshole to get his lines
 right the first time and maybe we'd
 be done by... 3 hours ago!

JAKE
 (sarcastically)
 It's my fault that I have a hard
 time acting like I'm attracted to
 you! Us, romantically? Ew.

Alex rolls his eyes. It's a bit playful.

ALEX

Oh, shut up.

The auditorium falls quiet. After an awkward silence.

STERLING

By the way, my parents are out of the house again. Do y'all wanna come over and drink to celebrate once we wrap?

JAKE

Dude, are your parents ever home?

Sterling shrugs.

JENNA

Less talking, more filming! Get into position.

Jake flips through the script to the end. Alex has his own script. They both memorize their lines for a second, before getting into position. Jake, in his warden outfit, puts handcuffs on Alex and gets ready to remove them.

JENNA

And... action!

Jake fumbles with the keys as he tries to unlock Alex's handcuffs. Neither of them are very good at acting.

JAKE

(weak, kinda cheesy acting)

Jordan, I knew you were innocent from the moment you stepped into this jail. I can't believe you're finally getting out of here!

ALEX

(stilted acting)

I can't believe I've lost so much of my life because I was framed by somebody drunk driving. I would never drive drunk, the D.A.R.E. program taught me well!

Sterling looks over at Jenna, puzzled at this strange writing.

JENNA

(sighs)

Mrs. Washington wanted me to include something about stopping drug addiction, so I wrote it in.

Sterling gets it. Back to Jake and Alex.

JAKE

Now that we're out of the prison, I have a confession. I am in love with you, Alex.

JENNA

Cut!

Alex rolls his eyes. Jake is confused.

JAKE

What happened? I thought that was great.

JENNA

Uh, Jake, his character is Jordan.

JAKE

Oops! Heh. Freudian slip.

ALEX

A freudian slip means you secretly meant to say it, dumbass.

Jake stupidly looks at Alex.

ALEX

(realizing)

Oh. You probably did mean to say it.

STERLING

Let's keep this moving! And... act-

JENNA

What are you doing? That's my line.

STERLING

Sorry, I'm just getting a bit antsy.

Jenna eyes Sterling angrily. Jake and Alex get back into position.

JENNA

Action!

JAKE

Now that we're out of the prison, I
have a confession. I am in love
with you, Alex.

JENNA

Cut!

Sterling facepalms. Alex throws his hands up.

ALEX

Jesus Christ.

JAKE

I'm so sorry, guys! Freudian sl-

ALEX

STOP CALLING IT A FREUDIAN SLIP!

That shuts Jake up. They go back to positions.

JAKE

Now that we're out of prison, I
have a confession. I am in love
with you,
 (thinks hard about next
 word, says it slowly)
Jordan.

Alex puts his finger on Jake's lip.

ALEX

Joel, you don't have to say
anything more. We're on the same
page.

Alex slowly moves closer to Jake. He starts approaching for a
kiss...

...slowly...

...and gives him a quick peck on the cheek.

JENNA

Cut! What the hell was that? Look
at the script. What does it say? "A
passionate kiss is shared between
the two long-estranged lovers.
Juices drip down their faces like a
waterfall of pleasure."

Jake and Alex collectively side-eye Jenna.

JAKE

Were you reading a Colleen Hoover book while writing this? Why is it so... descriptive.

Alex points at Jake in agreement.

ALEX

I thought that was weird, too.
"Waterfall of pleasure?" What the hell does that even mean?

JENNA

Passion! PASSION!

JAKE

(mocking)
Passion, Alex.

That gets a smile out of Alex.

STERLING

Alex, think about this. When you're holding the Orange County Student Media Festival award for Best Same Sex Kiss, you'll be thanking that waterfall of pleasure.

ALEX

That's an awfully specific category. I just don't want -

Alex stops to think about it.

STERLING

I'll give you a hundred bucks.

Sterling reaches into his wallet and pulls out a few twenties. Alex quickly grabs them.

ALEX

(enthusiastic about cash)
Passion? Oh, I've got tons of that.
Let's do it again!

Cutting back to Alex's line.

ALEX

Joel, you don't have to say anything more. We're on the same page.

Alex grabs Jake and pulls him in for a kiss. Instead of taking his time, he goes right in for it.

Their kiss isn't quite romantic, but it certainly has the passion that Jenna wanted.

After a long, sloppy kiss, they pull apart. Jake looks starstruck.

JENNA

And... that's a wrap!

Jenna and Sterling clap for the two. Alex gives a little bow. Jake doesn't know what to do, he's still smiling over the kiss.

ALEX

(to Jake)

That's how acting is done, asshole.

JAKE

Want to act some more, later?

Alex playfully hits Jake on the arm.

STERLING

Alright, remember: party at my house tonight! One final celebration!

I/E. STERLING'S HOUSE - NIGHT

That night, Jake, wearing his warden outfit from earlier, stands in front of Sterling's house. Like usual, the music is pumping from the inside, juxtaposing the quiet outside.

JAKE

(to self)

Jake, you're the star. You've got this. Play it cool.

Jake shakes his nerves off and steps inside.

Inside, teenagers are littered throughout. Lots of conversations are happening on the side, with a large crowd in the middle of the living room. It looks the same as it always does.

Jake scans the room and sees that nobody else is wearing a costume.

He makes his way to the kitchen where the booze is laid out. Sterling is in the middle, finishing up a conversation with one of his friends. When done, Jake walks up.

JAKE
(over the music)
What the hell? I thought this was a
costume party!

STERLING
Huh? I literally never said that.

JAKE
Okay, well. Yeah, you didn't say
it. Look at me! I look like an
idiot.

Sterling shrugs. Not his problem.

STERLING
(playfully)
So... are you going to tell Alex
about your feelings?

JAKE
Who told you that?

Sterling points in the other corner of the kitchen. Jenna,
drunk out of her mind, cheers loudly.

JAKE
Jenna! Get over here!

Jenna stumbles over to Jake and Sterling.

JAKE
Yo, why did you tell Sterling?

JENNA
(drunkenly)
Tell him what? I didn't say
anything.

JAKE
Don't play dumb, you told him about
(whispers)
Alex.

Jenna stupidly looks at Jake. She has no idea what's
happening.

STERLING
Dude, I don't think she has to play
dumb, look at her! And... come on.
It's obvious.

Jenna sways under her drunkenness. Jake groans.

JAKE
 You guys didn't say anything to
 him, right?

Jenna and Sterling sit in silence. Jake looks between the two
 of the suspiciously. Under pressure:

JENNA
 I... might have said something
 about it.

Jake throws his arms up in frustration.

JAKE
 I wanted this to be a surprise!
 It'd be all cute and now it's
 ruined.
 (beat)
 Okay, not 'ruined' but c'mon.

JENNA
 (sadly)
 I'm sorry, Jake.

Jake, seeing Jenna's genuine sadness calms down.

JAKE
 It's fine. Sterling, uh, give me
 your strongest shot possible.

Sterling grabs a high APV bottle of vodka and pours Jake an
 enormous shot.

STERLING
 That'll put hair on your chest.

JAKE
 (points at both of them)
 Fuck the both of you.

Jake downs the large shot. He pulls Jenna and Sterling in for
 a hug.

JAKE
 Wish me luck!

STERLING
 You got this!

JENNA
 Good luck!

Jake stumbles a little bit as he walks out of the kitchen and
 into the backyard.

EXT. STERLING'S BACKYARD - CONTINUOUS

Closing the door behind him, Jake steps onto the lawn and walks to the dock. Alex is sitting on the steps, hitting his vape.

Jake sits in the chair next to Alex and looks out at the lake. The night is peaceful, and Jake doesn't open his mouth to speak just yet.

After a bit of silence:

JAKE

So, what's up with you?

Alex scoffs.

ALEX

I'll be honest with you, Jake. I'm not doing well. I lost my closest friend, my grades are failing, and I just embarrassed myself on video for a stupid short film.

JAKE

Embarrassed? I'm sorry if you thought it was embarrassing, but in my professional opinion it was beautiful. Very profound.

ALEX

(laughs)

'Professional opinion'? Come on.

JAKE

Hey, they don't give out third place at the Orange County District Short Film Slam Festival to anybody!

Alex lets out a brief laugh. After, they stare off into the distance for a beat.

ALEX

Jake, tell me honestly. What's up with this story about the time loop?

Jake doesn't know how to explain it. He racks his brain for an answer.

JAKE

The loop was my past. I've moved onto my future.

ALEX

If I believe you, though, why
aren't you more hung up on it?

JAKE

I dunno, man. It took me a long
time to realize this, but what I
was living in there wasn't a life.
While it was *my life*, it wasn't a
life. You know?

ALEX

(mockingly)

Woah. Deep.

JAKE

(playfully)

Shut up.

A beat.

ALEX

Did you really mean what you said
that night?

JAKE

Every word.

Another beat.

ALEX

I didn't know you were... you know.

JAKE

Bisexual?

ALEX

Yeah.

JAKE

I wasn't anything close to bisexual
before that loop.

ALEX

What made you realize?

JAKE

You did. I was happy with my
relationship with Sarah, but I
wasn't entirely happy because I
knew my attention could never be on
her.

ALEX

I just don't get it. How could you -
why me?

JAKE

Alex, I know you more than anybody
could possibly know you. I got more
information in that one practically
infinite day than I will ever learn
from you going forward.

ALEX

Is that not a problem, though? You
know everything about me. Even
though we've been friends forever,
you know... too much.

JAKE

Would you rather have me conceal my
feelings? I learned that life is
much easier when you're completely
honest.

ALEX

I guess that's fair.

Another dead-end to the conversation. From the patio:

STERLING

(yelling)

Have you told him yet?!

JAKE

(yelling back)

Told who what?

Jake turns around and signals for Sterling to shut the hell
up. He doesn't recognize the signal.

STERLING

Tell Alex about y-

JAKE

Shut up, Sterling!

STERLING

Oh. Sorry!

Sterling turns around and goes back inside. After a moment,
Alex bursts out into laughter.

JAKE

What?

ALEX

Nothing. You're ridiculous. You never learned how to keep your mouth shut, did you?

JAKE

When my actions have no consequence, it makes it a bit hard.

ALEX

How did you find out?

An abrupt change in tone from Alex. Jake is thrown off.

JAKE

Find out what?

ALEX

That I'm bi, too.

Jake stares into the distance, thinking hard. After a short beat:

ALEX

Jake? C'mon, you can't leave me hanging.

JAKE

I... don't remember. It was such a long time ago.

ALEX

Bullshit.

JAKE

I'm serious.

ALEX

Oh.

Alex looks off into the distance. After a moment, he sits up and looks at Jake. He grabs Jake's hands.

ALEX

Jake. You -

Alex sighs. He doesn't know how to say this. Jake reacts nervously.

ALEX

You don't know how long I've felt this way about you. I'm just...

Alex takes a deep breath. Jake looks on in anticipation.

ALEX

I'm at such a tough time in my life. My parents might accept me for who I am, but what if they don't?

Alex looks away.

JAKE

Alex, look at me. I will **always**, always be here for you. And I **know** that this world is a judgmental place but as long as we have each other's backs - who cares?

Jake looks deep into Alex's eyes.

ALEX

I love you, Jake.

JAKE

I love you, too.

The two stare at each other for a moment. It's cute.

ALEX

I would kiss you, but I think we already got that out of the way.

Jake smiles, and doesn't respond. He interlaces his fingers with Alex's, and leans back in his chair. The two of them look into the lake.

ALEX

(chuckles)

I swear to God, if you got stuck in another loop and just perfected this day...

JAKE

I can prove that I didn't.

Jake pulls out his phone, and Alex looks over. **11:59 PM** turns to **12:00 AM**. Jake puts his phone away and looks back at the lake. As we pull away:

ALEX

Wait, you're telling me that at midnight you just got flung back to the next morning? What happened if you were doing something?

JAKE

Don't ask questions. It's too complicated.

Alex stares at Jake, digging for an answer.

JAKE

Okay, if you really need to know, as soon as it hit 12:00, everything would go black and I would wake up at 6:07 AM.

ALEX

Why 6:07?

JAKE

Dude, stop asking questions. Let's enjoy the moment.

The two stare off at the lake.

I/E. AUDITORIUM - DAY

Weeks later, the school auditorium is packed with fancily-dressed students.

A banner: "Orange County Student Media Festival 2023".

Kids take photos holding small trophies in the hallway.

In the parking lot, Jake's family pulls up in a minivan. A FLORIDA GATORS sticker is on the back of the car, signaling Jake's end to his college admissions journey.

Melissa, Robert, Lucas, and Jake exit. Jake's wearing a full suit, while the rest of his family are dressed in church clothes. Lucas plays on his phone.

Jake wears a crooked blue bow tie. Melissa sees it and fixes it for him.

MELISSA

We're running late, Jake! Why don't you run on ahead? I don't want you to miss your categories.

ROBERT

We're going to be on the right side of the theater. Come see us after you get your award.

Melissa taps on Lucas's phone, signaling him to get off.

LUCAS
Oh. Good luck, Jake!

Jake ruffles Lucas's hair, and jogs off.

In the auditorium hallway, Alex taps his foot while waiting for Jake. Running late. Jake whips open the door.

ALEX
There you are!

JAKE
What'd I miss?

ALEX
Jenna won an award for directing
and best screenplay?

JAKE
Best screenplay? What was she
against, *The Room*?

ALEX
Beats me. However, we're up for
best in show... and I think we
could win.

JAKE
Oh, Alex. So optimistic.

Jake brushes through Alex's hair. Alex pulls away, trying to move ahead.

ALEX
Shut up.

Alex grabs Jake's hands and drags him into the theater. They find seats by Jenna and Sterling. Jenna holds multiple awards.

JENNA
There you are! Look at all of these
awards! Of course, this is all
thanks to you two.

JAKE
Thanks, Jenna. You deserve it all.

STERLING
Hold up, they're about to announce
it!

A screen on the stage projects: "BEST IN SHOW." An ANNOUNCER (50s) announces the contenders while the group waits.

ANNOUNCER

And now... for best in show!
Remember, here are the nominees:
Knightly Journeys.
Spaces, Places.
The Park Avenue Pack.
Murder Mayhem.
Finally, *Jailbird: A Love Story.*

After hearing their film, *Jailbird*, the group lets out a big whoop.

Jake looks over to Alex, who is anticipating the results.

They lock hands.

Melissa walks up to them and takes a photo.

MELISSA

Get together, you two!

JAKE

Mom, go to your seat!

She waves him off, clicks a photo, and happily walks away.

ANNOUNCER

Drumroll, please!

A drumroll.

Time slows down. Everybody seems to move in slow motion. Jake looks around the room.

Sterling and Jenna hug each other in nervousness.

Other teams of students lean in to hear the result.

Jake's family looks on in anticipation.

Jake turns his attention back to Alex, and time seems to resume.

ANNOUNCER

The winner, with a unanimous jury
decision...

Jake isn't worried. While everybody else looks nervous, he smiles. Before hearing the result:

CUT TO BLACK.

TITLE: "LOOPED"